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Portfolio cushion.
Where can investors fish for higher returns in a rising bond yields scenario
BIG STORY P2

Policy reset.
Change of guard at the Fed, and why it matters for gold and equities
YOUR MONEY P3

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Not just gold, love for equities too adds to BoP stress

BLIND SIDE. ‘Asset arbitrage’ is a factor as foreign direct investment repatriations and FII selling add fuel to fire

Hari Viswanath
bl. research bureau

When it rains, it pours. That seems to be the challenge India is facing on the balance of payments (BoP) front. While the situation remains manageable given the economy's inherent strengths and India's historical resilience, the pressures building on the BoP suggest that solutions may need to go beyond curbing gold imports and crude oil consumption, especially if the US/Israel-Iran conflict persists and its economic fallout proves prolonged.

Yes, gold imports have risen sharply over the last five years, from 1.3 per cent of GDP in FY21 to around 2 per cent in FY26. Oil imports, too, have increased from 3 per cent to over 4.5 per cent of GDP. But India has faced similar — and even higher — oil-import burdens in the past, without comparable currency stress. In FY22, oil imports were close to 5 per cent of GDP, yet the rupee weakened only 3.7 per cent against the dollar, compared with the 11 per cent decline in FY26. Similarly, in FY19, when crude imports were

around 5 per cent of GDP, the rupee fell about 6 per cent, far less severe than now.

The 11 per cent decline in FY26 marks the rupee's steepest fall since FY14. But unlike FY14, when forex reserves covered only about seven months of imports, India now has reserves equivalent to over 8 months of import cover.

Compared with five years ago, India's BoP position has deteriorated from a surplus of 3.3 per cent of GDP to a deficit of 1.33 per cent, based on FY26 BoP estimates by SBI Research.

BEYOND OIL & GOLD

A closer look suggests the biggest structural shifts lie beyond gold and petroleum imports.

Since March 2021, the rupee has depreciated 31 per cent. While incremental gold imports contributed about 0.7 percentage points of GDP to the worsening BoP, far bigger changes have emerged in capital flows. Net FDI flows have fallen from a positive 1.6 per cent of GDP in FY21 to near-flat levels now. Importantly, the decline is not due to weaker FDI inflows, which have remained between 2-3

Major elements of BoP

	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26
USDINR y-o-y change	3.3	-3.7	-8.4	-1.5	-2.5	-10.9
Balance of payments	3.3	1.5	-0.3	1.8	-0.1	-1.3*
Cur. Acc. Balance	0.9	-1.2	-2.0	-0.7	-0.6	-0.8*
Gross FDI [†]	3.1	2.7	2.2	2.0	2.1	2.6
Less: Repatriations [‡]	-1.0	-0.9	-0.9	-1.3	-1.4	-1.6
Less: net ODI [§]	-0.4	-0.6	-0.4	-0.5	-0.7	-0.9
Net FDI [¶]	1.6	1.2	0.8	0.3	0.0	0.1
FPI flows into equities	1.4	-0.6	-0.2	0.7	-0.4	-0.5
Gold imports**	1.3	1.5	1.1	1.3	1.6	2.0
Petroleum imports**	3.0	5.0	6.2	5.0	4.8	4.5
Forex cover*	13.4	9.5	7.7	9.0	8.6	8.4

*Based on BoP and CAD figures per SBI Research **Apr-Feb figures annualised for FY26 **Apr-Feb figures annualised for FY26. Petroleum imports could be a higher due to oil price spike in March Source: RBI, Ministry of Commerce, SBI Research Compiled by: Nishanth Gopalakrishnan

per cent of GDP, but because of rising repatriation of capital out of India.

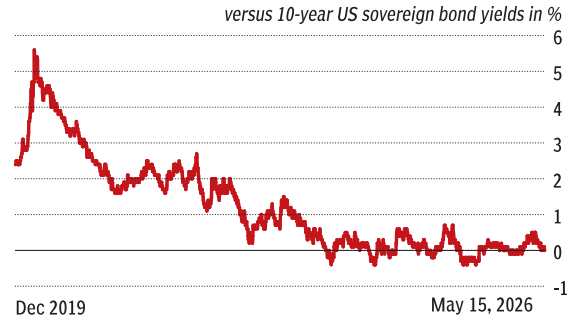
FDI repatriations have increased from 1 per cent of GDP in FY21 to 1.6 per cent in FY26. In six of the previous 10 fiscals, repatriations remained below 1 per cent of GDP. Except for FY21, however, they have stayed above that mark for the last three years, dragging down net FDI flows.

Net FPI equity flows have also weakened sharply, mov-

ing from a positive 1.4 per cent of GDP in FY21 to a negative 0.5 per cent in FY26. While FPI outflows were similarly negative in FY22 (-0.6 per cent), net FDI inflows at that time still stood at 1.2 per cent of GDP, compared with almost negligible levels now.

This is the core challenge confronting policy-makers. A spike in gold or oil imports can be managed in isolation. A temporary export slowdown due to tariff wars is also

Nifty's earnings yield differential contracting



Nifty's earnings yield differential = Nifty's earnings yield minus yield on 10-year sovereign bond Source: Bloomberg

manageable. But when all of these occur simultaneously — alongside elevated FDI repatriations, IPO-related exits and sustained FPI outflows — the pressure becomes far more serious. It is effectively a battle on multiple fronts.

HIGHER VALUATIONS

In February 2024, when Whirlpool Corporation sold a 24 per cent stake in its Indian subsidiary, its CEO remarked: *When you have a business trading at 50 times multiple when your own company trades a lot lower, it's an asset arbitrage.*

That example reflects a broader trend. Indian equi-

ties continue to trade at substantial premiums to global peers, even in sectors where growth differentials are limited. Large Indian IT services firms, for instance, still command significant valuation premiums over global bellwethers such as Accenture, despite comparable growth prospects.

Relative to global markets, Indian equities appear expensive, regardless of the debate around whether valuations are justified on an absolute basis. The S&P 500 is expected to deliver earnings growth of about 25 per cent in CY26 and trades at roughly 22 times forward

earnings. By contrast, the Nifty 500 is projected to post earnings growth of only around 8 per cent, yet trades at similar valuations.

On a trailing basis, the median P/E ratio for S&P 500 companies is 24x, with 64 per cent of firms trading below 30x earnings. For the Nifty 500, the median P/E is significantly higher at 34x, while only 40 per cent of companies trade below 30x.

Compounding the issue is the rise in global bond yields, which has reduced the relative attractiveness of Indian equities. The earnings yield of the Nifty 50 relative to 10-year bond yields in major economies has been steadily compressing, making Indian equities less attractive compared with risk-free assets and global AI-linked investment opportunities.

There could be various factors driving the relative over valuation — Indians' confidence in the country's growth prospects, favourable taxation regime for equities versus debt, speculation, etc. In the process the country is not only importing gold, but also importing ownership of Indian equities from foreigners at expensive valuations.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

Godrej Agrovet: Accumulate on dips

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Godrej Agrovet's 35 per cent correction from its peak has made the risk-reward more favourable for patient investors.

Investors with a 3/5-year view can accumulate the stock gradually on declines. The stock now trades at a reasonable valuation of around 17 times the FY28 estimated consensus earnings, while medium-term earnings growth is supported by two strong engines — palm oil and animal nutrition. FY26 showed visible improvement, with better margins, sharper working capital efficiency and ROCE of about 20 per cent.

Palm oil has emerged as the main profit driver, helped by plantation maturity, better extraction and value-added products. Animal nutrition is gaining from healthy volume growth, led by cattle feed. Crop care, dairy and Astec remain monitorables, but even there, recovery expectations are building.

TCS 'to build industry-specific AI systems'

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Tata Consultancy Services plans to build and manage a unified control plane, or an “AI Operating System”, across its full AI stack to deliver industry-specific AI systems, wrote CEO K Krithivasan in the company's FY25-26 annual report.

“Many enterprises have tools and models, but not the standardised control and context needed to run agentic systems safely in day-to-day operations,” he said. “This is where TCS is positioning itself as an Enterprise Intelligence Integrator — modernising software stacks, embedding AI agents into operations, and governing data and security at scale to deliver measurable outcomes.”

5-LAYER AI STACK

TCS is building its AI ser-



N Chandrasekaran, Chairman of Tata Sons

vices across five layers. The foundational layer provides the compute and infrastructure backbone for AI, including high-performance GPUs, specialised chips, scalable data centres, edge devices and cloud platforms. The company's HyperVault and SovereignCloud initiatives are part of this layer.

The second layer focusses on converting large language models (LLMs), small language models (SLMs) and industry-trained frameworks

into actionable intelligence.

The third layer provides platforms and tools to build, deploy and govern AI solutions.

The fourth layer embeds AI into core business workflows through intelligent enterprise applications, while the fifth connects AI systems to real-world outcomes using robotics, edge AI, conversational and visual interfaces, and decision intelligence integrated into operations.

FOUR FOCUS AREAS

TCS Chairman N Chandrasekaran outlined four focus areas for the company's Enterprise Intelligence Integrator strategy: building an AI operating system for industries, developing India's first AI-focussed data centre with rack density above 160 KW, strengthening its Infrastructure-to-Intelligence offerings through partnerships, and creating

secure, resilient and sovereign AI infrastructure.

“GenAI and agentic AI are entering a new phase of growth. AI will not just be a layer, but the operating foundation,” he said.

CAUTION

Commenting on TCS' AI Operating System ambitions, Sanchit Vir Gogia, Co-Founder and Chief Analyst at Greyhound Research, cautioned enterprises against getting “carried away by the poetry of the report”.

TCS reported annualised revenues of \$2.3 billion from AI services and \$11.5 billion from new-age services, including cloud, data, enterprise solutions and cybersecurity.

Alongside acquisitions such as Coastal Cloud for \$700 million and ListEngage for \$72.8 million, the company said it plans to expand next-generation capabilities through further inorganic growth initiatives.

Govt restricts silver bar imports after duty hike

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Days after sharply raising the import duty on gold, silver and platinum and capping duty-free gold imports for use in jewellery exports, the Centre has tightened import norms for select categories of silver bars by moving them from the “free” to the “restricted” category. The latest move, notified by the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), is part of a broader clampdown on precious metal inflows amid concerns over surging imports, pressure on the trade deficit and weakening of the rupee.

Under the revised policy, import of certain silver bars will now require government authorisation. On May 13, the government raised the import duty on gold and silver to 15 per cent from 6 per cent and on platinum to 15.4 per cent from 6.4 per cent.

HISTORIC RETURN



CHOLA LEGACY. Prime Minister Narendra Modi examines historical artefacts returned to India by Leiden University during his two-day visit to the Netherlands on Saturday. The Netherlands formally handed over 11th century Chola dynasty copper plates — known as the Leiden Plates — in a ceremony attended by Modi and his Dutch counterpart Rob Jetten, marking strengthened bilateral ties. India has been seeking the return of the Anaimangalam Copper Plates since 2012 REUTERS

Aditya Birla Group to infuse equity of ₹4,730 crore in Vodafone Idea

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

The Aditya Birla Group on Saturday committed an equity infusion of \$500 million (₹4,730 crore) in debt-ridden telco Vodafone Idea (Vi), as per an exchange filing.

On the day of Vi's fourth quarter results, the board also approved the issuance of fully convertible warrants worth ₹4,730 crore (\$500 million) to Promoter Group Aditya Birla on a preferential basis. Each warrant is convertible into one fully paid-up equity share.

Over the years, the Group has invested around ₹27,000 crore in Vi, as indicated by Sushil Agarwal, Chief Financial Officer and Director of Aditya Birla in Vi's earlier investor's meet.

“Issuance of up to 430

crore warrants (each convertible into one equity share) to Suryaja Investments Pte Ltd, Singapore, (an Aditya Birla Group entity and Promoter Group Company), at an issue price of ₹11 per warrant, aggregating to ₹4,730 crore on a preferential basis (Preferential Issue),” said the Vi exchange filing.

The board also called for an extraordinary general meeting on June 11 to seek approval of the shareholders for the preferential issue. The development comes days after Kumar Mangalam Birla, Chairperson of Aditya Birla, returned as the Chairman of Vi on May 5.

AGR RELIEF

In April, the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) gave a major relief to Vodafone Idea on its long-

pending adjusted gross revenue (AGR) dues, reducing the payable amount to ₹64,046 crore as of December 31, 2025, from ₹87,695 crore earlier. Under the revised payment schedule, Vi will pay ₹126 crore between March 2026 and March 2031, followed by a minimum of ₹100 crore annually from March 2032 to March 2035. The remaining ₹10,608 crore will then be repaid over six years until March 2041. The company must also pay spectrum usage charges of ₹609 crore, along with interest.

Vi's bank debt stood at ₹726 crore in the March quarter, down sharply from ₹2,326 crore a year earlier.

Chairman Birla had increased his stake in Vi by 2.21 crore shares on January 30 and another 1.88 crore shares on February 1 at ₹11.13 per share.

Delhi cuts VAT on jet fuel to 7% for 6 months

Our Bureau
New Delhi

After Maharashtra, the Delhi government on Saturday lowered the value added tax (VAT) on jet fuel to 7 per cent from 25 per cent. This is expected to provide big relief to airlines for whom fuel accounts for over 40 per cent of their operating cost.

“The concessional rate will initially remain in force for a period of six months,” Rekha Gupta, Chief Minister of Delhi, said. Further, the decision, taken in the interest of both the nation and Delhi, may result in an estimated revenue loss of nearly ₹985 crore for the government, she added.

She said the VAT on ATF generates annual revenues of around ₹1,368 crore, accounting for nearly 19 per cent of the Delhi government's total annual VAT collection.

Gulf war cuts India's LPG imports by 4.3 lakh barrels/day

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The closure of the Strait of Hormuz, through which India gets nearly two-thirds of its LPG imports, sharply disrupted supplies of the cooking fuel, with imports falling by about 430,000 barrels per day (b/d) or 430 kb/d in March-April.

The International Energy Agency, in its latest commentary on the impact of the West Asia conflict on liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) flows, said the crisis had triggered an unprecedented global energy shock.

Around 3.4 billion people across developing countries depend on LPG as the primary cooking fuel. In 2025, about 30 per cent of global seaborne LPG exports transited through the Strait, the agency noted.

INDIA HIT HARDEST

“India's LPG imports have



been particularly affected, dropping by more than half during the first two months of the conflict, a loss of around 430 kb/d,” the IEA said.

To offset the shortfall, the government directed domestic refineries to maximise LPG production, adding an estimated 180 kb/d. Additional demand curbs were also introduced to reduce the impact on supplies.

Companies secured some alternative cargoes, but supplies from the US take nearly 40 days to reach

Mumbai, compared with just four-five days from the Gulf region.

India's LPG storage capacity covers a little over 10 days of consumption, offering only a limited cushion during supply disruptions. The shortage hit commercial users the hardest, with many unable to access pre-conflict supply volumes, while both commercial and household consumers faced sharply higher prices in unregulated markets.

SUPPLY SHOCK

The IEA said LPG exports through the Strait plunged about 80 per cent in March, falling from an average 1.5 million barrels per day (mb/d) in 2025 to just 0.3 mb/d during the conflict.

Almost all Middle East LPG exports were shipped to Asia in 2025, with nearly 60 per cent used by homes, restaurants, street vendors and commercial establish-

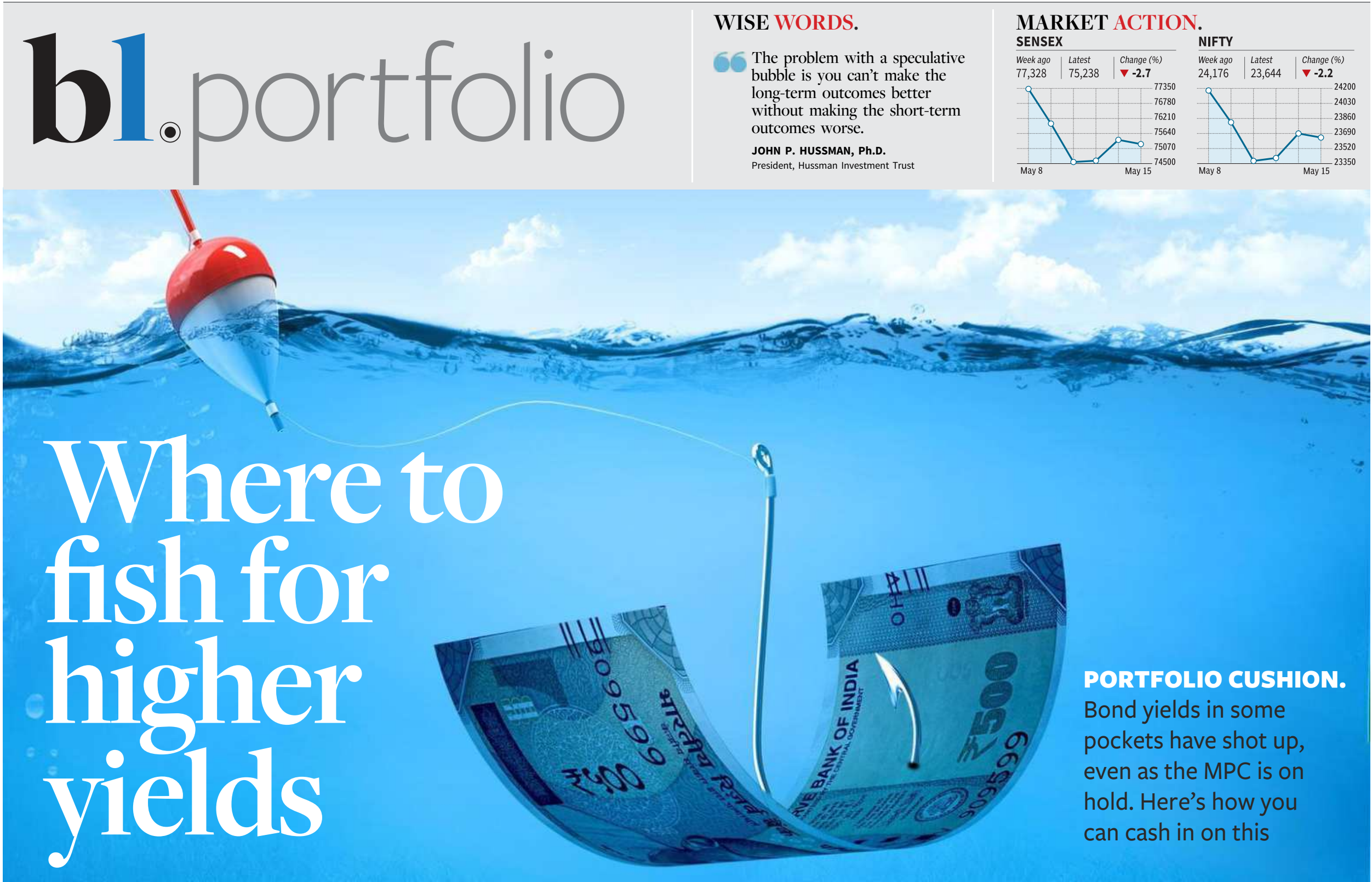
ments — enough to meet the cooking needs of around 820 million people.

The remaining volumes were largely used for water heating and as feedstock for petrochemicals, particularly in China, where some flexibility exists to switch to alternative feedstocks.

INFRA DAMAGE

The agency also noted that damage to LPG infrastructure in Qatar, Oman and Iran has resulted in production losses of around 170 kb/d. Eight additional LPG-related facilities in the region were reportedly hit, though the extent of the damage remains unclear.

LPG prices surged sharply in March, with benchmark rates in India and East Africa rising as much as 90 per cent above 2025 average, while West African prices climbed about 70 per cent.



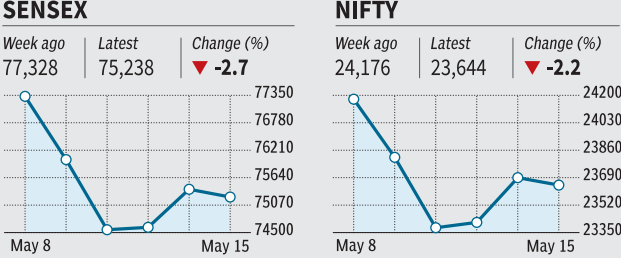
Where to fish for higher yields

WISE WORDS.

“The problem with a speculative bubble is you can’t make the long-term outcomes better without making the short-term outcomes worse.”

JOHN P. HUSSMAN, Ph.D.
President, Hussman Investment Trust

MARKET ACTION.



PORTFOLIO CUSHION.

Bond yields in some pockets have shot up, even as the MPC is on hold. Here’s how you can cash in on this

Aarati Krishnan

With the oil shock beginning to make itself felt, returning inflation looks set to take the shine out of both gold and equities. The recent spike in India’s Wholesale Price Index to 8 per cent plus suggests that corporate earnings, after a robust Q4 FY26, can take a breather over the next few months as companies try to pass on pinching input costs to consumers.

Global gold prices tend to be inversely correlated to treasury (government bond) yields. As US inflation rears its head and developed market bonds see a rise in yields, investors may make a beeline for treasuries instead of gold.

However, in investing, whenever opportunities in some asset classes recede, they crop up in others. Today, bonds are turning more attractive for investors, with rising inflation expectations and the renewed possibility of policy rate hikes.

India’s Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) has slashed repo rates by 125 basis points through 2025 and is now sitting on the pause button. But with bond markets responding to the recent oil shock, bond yields in many sections of the market are already ruling at levels that prevailed before these rate cuts!

If low-key tensions in West Asia continue, crude oil remains at \$85 plus and the looming El Nino disrupts crop production, analysts are now betting that inflation can shoot past 5 per cent. Should this happen, the MPC can take its finger off the pause button to restart a rate hike cycle.

BOND YIELDS RISING

Bond markets always run well ahead of policy actions. Therefore, market yields on bonds have already been rising sharply on expectations of the next rate hike cycle. The yield on the 10-year government security (G-Sec), the benchmark for the bond market, bottomed out at 5.9 per cent in May 2025 and has since climbed to 7.1 per cent now. These are levels that prevailed in 2025 before repo rate cuts began.

Yields on other bonds have climbed in tandem too. (See Table 1). This throws up buying opportunities for investors looking to improve the returns on the debt component of their portfolios.

On the flip side, though, rising rates hurt bond prices. Therefore, while shooting for higher yields, it is also important to limit the losses on your bond holdings from any further rise in rates.

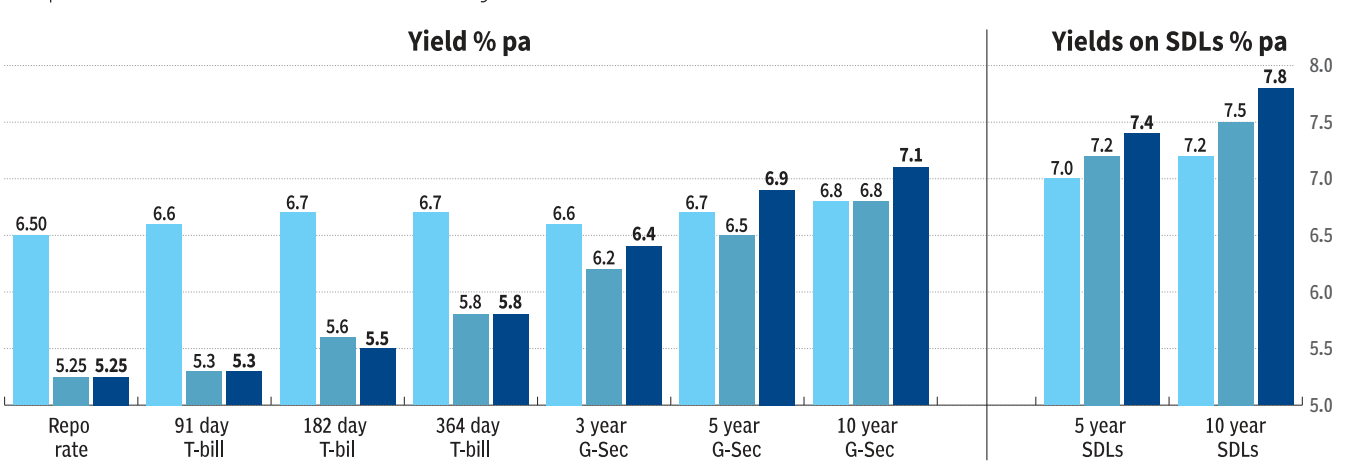
We analysed the entire gamut of bond options, to come up with three sets of high-yielding opportunities that investors can tap today, to balance risk with reward. Do note that we have looked at bonds more from a wealth-creation perspective than the need to generate regular income.

SDLs: SAFETY PLUS YIELD

Historically, the best times to invest in Central G-Secs in India was when the yield on the 10-year G-Sec hovered between 7.5 per cent and 8 per cent. Yields today are well below those levels at 7.1 per cent. However, State Development Loans or SDLs present a high-yield opportunity.

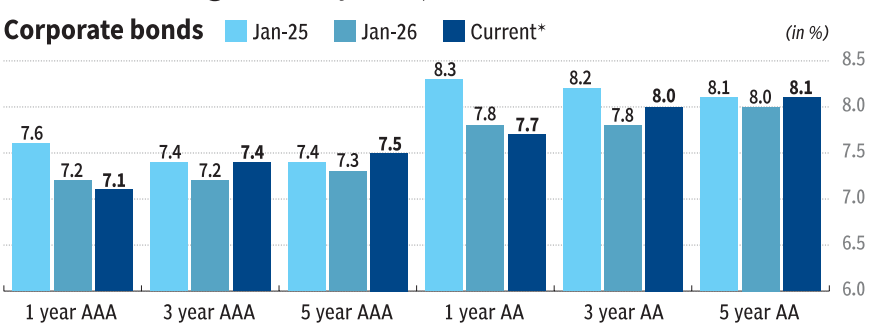
If you look at historical data, SDLs have usually traded at a 30-40 basis point spread over G-Secs of similar tenure. Since the be-

Repo rates down, but G-Sec yields rise



*As of May 16, 2026

Yields are high for 3 year plus tenures



*As of May 16 2026

ginning of 2026, however, SDLs are offering attractive yields because the SDL spread has widened to 70-80 basis points.

State governments in India have become more prodigious borrowers than the Centre, leading to the market demanding higher yields from them.

Effectively, investors can earn yields as high as 7.6-7.8 per cent by investing in State government bonds, against around 7 per cent from comparable Central G-Secs. Theoretically, State governments are slightly riskier entities than the Central government, because they are reliant on the Centre for funds. However, SDLs still offer near-sovereign safety because the servicing of these loans is managed by the RBI (Reserve Bank of India) through an escrow mechanism. There is no past case of a State government in India defaulting on, or delaying a SDL payout. SDLs are also offering higher yields than many PSU and AAA-rated private sector bonds, presenting a sound investment opportunity.

A caveat here. SDLs are a very different instrument from bonds floated by State government entities such as State-promoted power corporations, transport corporations and infrastructure development corporations which offer yields of 9-10 per cent. These bonds are risky bets — not explicitly guaranteed by States and known to suffer from delayed payments in the past.

What to buy: Retail investors looking to buy individual SDLs can open an account with the RBI Retail Direct platform. This allows retail investors to invest sums starting from ₹10,000 in Central G-Secs and SDLs. Weekly auction calendars are emailed to you in advance. You need to wait for SDLs of the desired tenure to be auctioned, so you can participate.

The latest SDL auction on May 8, for instance, offered bonds with maturity dates ranging from 2032 to 2056 and yields ranging from 7.5 per cent to 7.9 per cent. Do note that SDLs bought in auctions need to be held to maturity, as they carry limited secondary market liquidity.

If you want to participate in the SDL opportunity without liquidity issues, debt funds investing in indices made up of SDLs offer a good alternative.

Mutual fund houses manage a large menu of SDL-only funds, SDL plus G-Sec funds and SDL plus PSU bond funds that mature on specific target dates. These offer efficient, low-cost vehicles to park your debt money if you can find a fund that matches your desired tenure.

Today, if looking to park two-year money, Kotak SDL plus AAA PSU Bond July 2028 Index Fund and ABSL Crisil June 2032 Fund are the highest yield options with YTM of 7.6 per cent and 7.5 per cent respectively, at annual expenses of 0.20-0.21 per cent. Valueresearchonline.com has a comprehensive list of passive debt products from which you can choose the right SDL fund.

UTI has a similar SDL plus PSU bond fund maturing in April 2028 yielding 6.98 per cent with a similar cost. For five- to six-year tenures, Kotal SDL April 2032 Top 12 Index Fund and ABSL Crisil June 2032 Fund are the highest yield options with YTM of 7.6 per cent and 7.5 per cent respectively, at annual expenses of 0.20-0.21 per cent. Valueresearchonline.com has a comprehensive list of passive debt products from which you can choose the right SDL fund.

FRSBs: CAPITALISE ON THE RISE

Usually, debt investors shy away from floating rate bonds because of variable returns. But when the economic outlook tells you that rates can only flat-line or go up, floating rate bonds make plenty of sense.

There are three ways for Indian investors

to participate in floating rate bonds. They can buy floating rate debt mutual funds, government bonds pegged to floating rates or the retail GOI floating rate savings bonds sold by banks and RBI Retail Direct platform. Of the three, the last is the most viable option.

With very few private issues of floating rate bonds, floating rate debt funds often invest in fixed rate bonds and use swaps to mimic floating rates, which leads to these funds imperfectly mimicking floating rates.

The RBI periodically auctions floating rate bond borrowings by the Centre. These bonds offer yields that are 64-100 basis points higher than the 182-day treasury bill rate (the average of the last three auctions). The current 182-day T-bill yield is about 5.5 per cent. However, because of the peg to the six-month T-bill, these bonds are usually suitable only as short-term parking grounds. You also need to know when the next floating rate auction is coming up and participate in it.

What to buy: The Government of India’s Floating Rate Savings Bonds (FRSBs) meant for retail investors are the only practical option for investors looking to ride the rate cycle through floating rates. These bonds peg their interest rate to a 35-basis point spread over the prevailing interest rate on the NSC. This is a small savings scheme for which the government resets interest rates every quarter.

FRSBs have offered an island of high rates to investors across rate cycles, because when policy rates fall, the government tends to shield NSC from deep cuts. When rates rise, NSC rates tend to rise. They are also fixed 25 basis points above the five-year G-Sec yield. This allows FRSB investors to earn nearly 60 basis points above prevailing G-Sec rate at any given point in time. The current floating rate on FRSBs is 8.05 per cent per annum.

These bonds can be bought from banks or the RBI’s Retail Direct. However, the only negative is that these bonds have half-yearly interest, which is paid out and carry no cumulative option. They are neither listed nor tradeable and carry a seven-year lock-in period. However, the ability to park any amount in these bonds with no age restrictions is a big plus.

CORPORATE BONDS

Apart from SDLs, corporate bonds have also seen their spreads over G-Secs widen sharply in the past year, presenting opportunities for bond investors (See Table 2).

While yields on short-term corporate bonds (upto one year) are 40-50 basis points below 2025 levels, yields on bonds with three-

Three high-yield opportunities

Why buy	How to buy
State development loans	
Trading at 7.6-7.8% yield, 70-80 bps spread over g-secs	SDL Auctions in RBI Retail Direct or SDL index funds
Floating rate bonds	
Will deliver better returns with rising rates	GOI's Floating Rate Savings Bonds (Retail) from banks or RBI Retail Direct
Protect capital in rate rise	
Highly rated NBFC bonds	
Trading at 7.5-9% yield	Online bond platforms or passive debt MFs investing in NBFC bonds

year-plus maturity are back to levels that prevailed before the rate cuts started. Currently, AAA-rated corporate bonds offer yields of about 7.4-7.5 per cent for three-year tenures. Those rated at AA offer 8 per cent for the same tenure. Within corporate bonds, NBFC bonds offer an island of higher returns.

What to buy: Investors can earn higher yields from this space in three ways.

1 You can buy individual AAA- or AA-rated bonds from online bond platforms. However, as these platforms tend to aggressively promote lower-rated bonds with high yields, it is important to keep off bonds with default risks. Bonds from listed entities backed by reputed business groups with AAA or AA credit ratings from CRISIL, ICRA or CARE are the safer bets. Currently, for instance, the Indiabonds platform has a CARE AA-plus rated bond from Cholamandalam Finance maturing in June 2029 and a CRISIL AAA-rated bond from Aditya Birla Capital maturing in April 2036 both at an 8 per cent yield, which are worth a look. Make sure to avoid any bonds offering double-digit yields. The higher the yield compared to G-Secs (which trade at 6.2-7 per cent), the greater your risk of losing your principal!

2 You can buy passive index funds that focus on highly-rated NBFC bonds. Currently, for investors with 2-year money, Edelweiss CRISIL IBX AAA Financial Services Bond January 2028 Index Fund (7.7 per cent YTM), Kotak Nifty AAA Financial Services March 2028 Fund (7.7 per cent YTM), Nippon Crisil AAA Financial Services January 2028 (7.7 per cent YTM) are some of the top options. For five-year money, Bharat Bond ETF 2031 (7.5 per cent YTM) is a good bet. Valueresearch-online listings can help you find funds with the right tenures.

3 You can buy actively-managed corporate bond funds, after filtering them for healthy YTM and low costs. Currently, Franklin India Corporate Bond Fund (7.8 per cent YTM and 0.25 per cent direct plan cost), ICICI Pru Corporate Bond Fund (7.75 per cent YTM and 0.36 per cent cost) and SBI Corporate Bond Fund (YTM of 7.75 per cent and 0.37 per cent expenses) fit the bill. Most of these portfolios are invested in AAA-rated debt. Given their average portfolio maturity of five years, these options are more suited to your three- to five-year money.

The author is a Contributing Editor

Federal Reserve and the story of gold vs equities

POLICY RESET. As Kevin Marsh takes over as US Federal Reserve Chair, key questions arise on how inflation and prices will behave, and which asset classes will outperform

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl, research bureau

An epochal change of guard was triggered in motion last week with Kevin Warsh getting Senate confirmation of his appointment as the next Chairman of the US Fed’s Board of Governors and Jerome Powell stepping down. As the most influential central bank in the world, the actions of the US Fed have had anywhere between moderate to significant impact on investors across the world. As Powell hands over the baton after eight years at the helm, Warsh takes charge at one of the most tumultuous times in US Fed’s history, with the added pressure of a President constantly trying to influence the Fed’s independence.

Warsh has his work cut out, especially on the inflation front. The PCE (personal consumption expenditure) price index, which the Fed targets to keep under 2 per cent, has now remained above the target level for 61 months straight—the longest since such targeting was started in 2012. It has recently crept substantially to 3.5 per cent in March — the index’s latest reading, from 2.8 per cent in February. Higher energy prices are starting to show up in the inflation print. Long-term yields have gone up by about 100 bps since September 2024 despite a 175-bps cut in the Fed Funds Rate (FFR) in the same period. On Friday alone, Powell’s last day in office, US 10-year yields spiked a considerable 12 bps. How about that for a send off!

And if this wasn’t enough, as Powell departs, the Fed’s Open Market Committee is the most divided (apparently driven by politics too) in 34 years with the recent FOMC decision receiving four dissents—the highest since 1992.

Taming inflation rather eliciting the perception thereof would be crucial for Warsh and investors alike, going forward. Here we look back at an episode in history where failure to rein inflation meant investors benefitted by buying gold over equities and why

How asset classes fared under Fed Chairpersons

							
	Arthur F Burns	G William Miller	Paul A Volcker	Alan Greenspan	Ben S Bernanke	Janet L Yellen	Jerome H Powell
Term	Feb 1970 - Jan 1978	Mar 1978 - Aug 1979	Aug 1979 - Aug 1987	Aug 1987 - Jan 2006	Feb 2006 - Jan 2014	Feb 2014 - Feb 2018	Feb 2018 - May 2026
Gold returns (CAGR %)	22.4	34.3	6.1	1.1	10.3	1.7	16.4
S&P 500 returns (CAGR %)	0.6	13.4	15.6	7.6	4.2	11.6	12.8
US 10-year yield change (bps)*	19	88	-20	-420	-187	20	175

*Change in yield of 10-year sovereign bonds over their term Source: Bloomberg

investors need to pay heed to the Fed’s actions closely from here. For equities to outperform gold, Warsh has to get the house in order.

BURNS AND INFLATION
Before hopping on the time machine, here’s an interesting stat. In Powell’s term which spanned eight years (two terms of four years each), gold has outperformed equities. While a 13-per cent CAGR for equities is no bad thing, gold has beaten equities by a comfortable margin with a CAGR of 16 per cent. This puts Powell in the bottom half of the table of Fed Chairs in the last five decades under whose term gold outperformed equities.

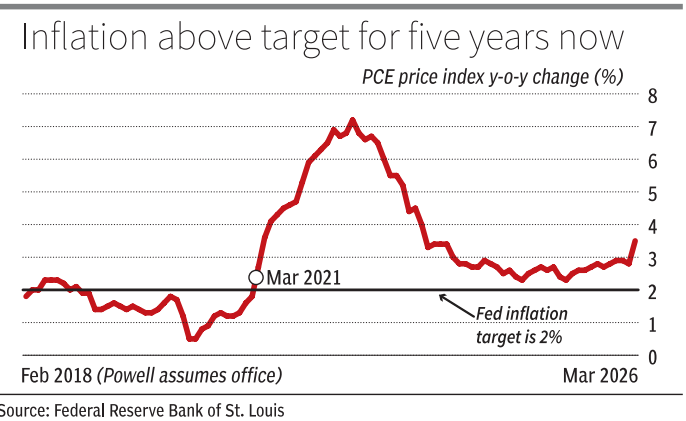
Occupying the bottom half alongside Powell is Arthur Burns, under whose term gold trounced equities. When he assumed office in February 1970, inflation (PCE price index) was as high as 5 per cent, driven up primarily by expansive spending on the war in Vietnam and social welfare programmes funded by government debt. The FFR was also commensurately high at 9.75 per cent (positive real returns). Inflation did cool to about 3 per cent. How-

● **INFLATION PANGS**

History suggests that a delayed or inadequate response to inflation can prove costly for equities

ever, ahead of the Presidential election in 1972, the Fed apparently succumbed to political pressure from the incumbent Nixon administration, thereby prematurely lowering the FFR to as low as 3.5 per cent by February 1971. An artificial short-term boom, consequently, handed Nixon a win but not so much for the US economy. Inflation soared to a peak of around 12 per cent by 1974-end, coupled with the 1973 oil shock, giving rise to a cost-of-living crisis. The economy tumbled into a stagflation — a period of weak economic growth and high inflation. Basically, no one wants to consume in such times. The Fed eventually played catch up to quell inflation by raising the FFR to 13 per cent. As an inflation hedge, gold soared but equities faltered.

That wasn’t all. Burns believed the inflation was caused by transi-



ent supply-side concerns and it did not have a lot to do with monetary policy or extravagant government spending. He even disregarded ‘volatile’ food and fuel from the inflation basket and only targeted the other constituents (core inflation) — thus getting back to pumping liquidity and lowering the FFR to around 5 per cent by 1976-end. Inflation also declined to an equivalent 5 per cent by then. But Burns did not realise it was only artificial and that inflation would come back with a vengeance in the start of the 1980s.

William Miller took charge as

the next Fed Chair as Burns’ term expired. He, too, had similar beliefs to Burns on inflation and continued to have a dovish stance. Inflation, which had settled at around 6 per cent when he assumed office, quickly spiralled out of control towards 9 per cent by July 1979. FFR was taken upward to over 10.5 per cent—but it was too late, too little and the damage had been done already. While Burns poured gasoline on inflation, Miller lit the match. Dollar started plummeting and markets had completely lost faith in the Fed by then, leading the Carter government to replace

Miller with Paul Volcker.

VOLCKER SHOCK
When Volcker took charge, he pulled a masterstroke. Shortly after assuming office, he cranked the FFR to an unprecedented 20 per cent by March 1980 and shocked the markets. This while inflation was still around the 12 per cent mark, driving massive real returns. More than the numbers, it restored faith in the Fed that inflation will be defeated. The perception mattered.

However, this meant the economy underwent couple of recessions—a short one in 1980 and a longer one in 1981-82. These were bitter pills for the economy to swallow to correct the monetary excesses infused over a decade-and-a-half. By early 1982, inflation had cooled rapidly to around 5.5 per cent and then it went on a gradual decline to 3.3 per cent when Volcker’s second term expired. A notable feature of Volcker’s term is that even after the FFR was lowered from 20 per cent, it was always maintained at a substantial margin over the inflation rate (average of 5.3 per cent and a minimum of about 3.4 per cent), encouraging savings and

thus removing liquidity excesses. Equities outperformed gold in his tenure (see table).

What’s more important is that Volcker set up a perfect stage for his successor Alan Greenspan, nicknamed the ‘Maestro’ (due to his roots in music) who ‘conducted’ the economy through a golden period of growth with controlled inflation. Markets liked him and he went on to serve the second longest term as the Fed Chair spanning 18.5 years across five presidents (both Democratic and Republican). Nevertheless, he became a bit too market-friendly towards the end of his final term, laying down the foundations of the 2008 sub-prime mortgage crisis. His consistent dovish inclinations after the recession in 2001 was one of the causes of the housing bubble, which eventually culminated in the global financial crisis of 2007-08.

GOING FORWARD
Warsh is about to take over when the world is going through tumultuous times. History suggests that a delayed or inadequate response to inflation can prove costly for equities. The recent rise in bond yields reflects the market’s scepticism over the Fed’s ability to keep inflation expectations anchored.

Warsh, therefore, has a rough road ahead to navigate. The key questions now are whether the Fed will remain independent, will prices rise, whether inflation will be managed effectively, and which asset classes will fare best over the medium term. For investors across the world too, this matters whenever they revisit their asset allocation between gold and equities.

Powell himself reveres Volcker and has admired him as the ‘greatest public servant in the economic arena’. However, given the Fed’s failure to tame inflation under 2 per cent for five years now, the jury is still out on Powell’s legacy and might risk being written alongside that of Burns and Miller, rather than that of Volcker.

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Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Motilal Oswal Mutual Fund has entered the contra fund category with an NFO in May, adding to a relatively under-populated segment that currently houses only three schemes: SBI Contra, Invesco India Contra and Kotak Contra Fund. The launch comes at a time when the category, though small, has quietly built a track record that merits closer scrutiny. The key question is whether these funds have consistently outperformed broader benchmarks over the long term, and how their stock-picking frameworks differ.

Contra funds invest in stocks or sectors that are currently out of favour and ignored by the market, betting on a turnaround in sentiment and business performance. In contrast, value funds focus on stocks trading below their intrinsic or fundamental value, irrespective of market popularity. While value investors may still buy popular companies if valuations are attractive, contra investors generally avoid crowded trades and prefer neglected opportunities linked to market inefficiencies.

The category's limited size can be traced to SEBI's 2017 classification norms, which required fund houses to offer either a value fund or a contra fund, but not both. Consequently, AMCs largely gravitated towards value strategies, leading to over 40 such schemes across active and passive categories. However, a regulatory shift in February 2026 now permits AMCs to operate both categories, subject to portfolio overlap remaining below 50 per cent.

PERFORMANCE TRACK RECORD

Despite its small universe, the contra category has delivered competitive returns. Over the last 10 years, five-year rolling returns averaged about 19 per cent CAGR, outperforming the Nifty 50 TRI (15 per cent) and Nifty 500 TRI (17 per cent). Flexi-cap funds, often considered a comparable diversified category, delivered around 16 per cent.

Within the segment, SBI Contra has been the standout performer, generating 22 per cent CAGR on this measure, followed by Kotak Contra and Invesco India Contra at 18 per cent and 17 per cent, respectively. On a three-year rolling basis too, contra funds maintained an edge, delivering about 18 per cent compared with 15 per cent for the Nifty 500 TRI.

DIVERGENT FRAMEWORKS

Each fund house deploys a distinct framework to identify contrarian opportunities.

SBI Contra adopts a three-bucket approach: turnaround, cyclical and value. Turnaround ideas focus on companies facing temporary operational or financial stress but with identifiable triggers such as management change or restructuring. The cyclical bucket tracks sectors nearing the bottom of their cycles, using indicators such as capacity utilisation and pricing



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

power. The value segment targets overlooked businesses trading at significant discounts to long-term potential.

Kotak Contra builds a contrarian universe from its research coverage of over 550 stocks. Eligibility is based on five predefined filters: underperformance versus the NSE 500 index, trading below long-term average valuations, lower valuation multiples relative to sector peers, sectoral underperformance versus the benchmark, or trading below the 200-day moving average. From this universe, the fund applies its BMV framework (business,

management and valuation) to identify fundamentally-strong companies with re-rating potential. The final portfolio usually consists of 50-60 stocks.

Invesco India Contra focuses on four categories of opportunities: companies in a turnaround phase, stocks trading below fundamental value, businesses benefiting from cyclical upturns and growth companies available at attractive valuations. It actively takes overweight and underweight sector calls against the benchmark based on valuation opportunities and sector rotation trends. The portfolio is mandated to maintain about 50-

60 per cent exposure to value-oriented ideas.

The new Motilal Oswal Contra Fund plans to follow a “contra growth” strategy, differentiating itself from existing contra schemes that largely adopt a value-oriented approach while identifying contrarian opportunities. The fund aims to identify opportunities arising from sectoral dislocations, low investor interest, weak analyst coverage and valuation gaps relative to sector averages. The strategy categorises ideas into short-, medium- and long-term opportunities. It will primarily use the PEG (price/earnings-to-growth) framework targeting a portfolio PEG ratio of around 1.2 and focusing on companies with strong profit-growth visibility over the next two-three years. Key quality filters include operating cash flow-to-net worth, strong profit-to-cash-flow conversion and return ratios. The portfolio will remain concentrated with 25-30 high-conviction stocks and is unlikely to exceed 35 holdings.

CURRENT OPPORTUNITIES

Across funds, current positioning reflects a mix of cyclical and structural calls.

SBI Contra has identified oil and gas as a contrarian opportunity, citing temporary earnings pressure linked to geopolitical developments. It also sees selective turnaround opportunities in pharma, while remaining cautious on IT from a sectoral perspective. Over the last three months, the fund has newly added UPL and significantly increased exposure to E.I.D. Parry (India), ICICI Bank and Prism Johnson.

Kotak Contra remains overweight on financials, citing valuations are below long-term averages even as credit growth and

MIND IT

- Contra investing is inherently timing-sensitive
- Some beaten-down stocks may remain weak due to structural issues
- Contra funds can lag during momentum-driven bull markets

asset-quality trends improve. Healthcare is another preferred segment, particularly domestic pharma and hospital chains. Recent additions to the portfolio include Tata Steel, Indus Towers and Coal India.

Meanwhile, the fund manager of Motilal Oswal Contra sees short-term contrarian opportunities in auto, tyres and chemicals, where profitability has been temporarily impacted by elevated crude oil prices. The fund expects earnings recovery in these sectors once crude prices normalise over the coming quarters. Medium-term opportunities are being identified in banks, NBFCs and pharma. In financials, the fund expects greater clarity on asset quality and provisioning under the RBI's expected credit loss (ECL) norms over the next two quarters, which could help differentiate stronger lenders from weaker peers. For long-term contrarian opportunities, the fund manager identified IT as a key structural play. While near-term disruption and revenue pressure may persist, the fund believes quality IT companies could emerge stronger over the next two-three years.

INVESTMENT TAKEAWAYS

Contra investing is inherently timing-sensitive. Even well-founded ideas may remain out of favour for extended periods, leading to interim underperformance and testing investor patience. Another major risk is “value traps”, where beaten-down stocks fail to recover due to structural issues. Further, contra funds can lag during momentum-driven bull markets, as their portfolios are skewed towards under-owned or temporarily weak segments.

Not every stock in a contra fund portfolio necessarily represents a contrarian opportunity, as several holdings overlap with other diversified equity funds. While the initial stock selection is driven by contrarian ideas, portfolio exits are managed similarly to other actively-managed funds, based on factors such as weakening growth outlook, stretched valuations or deterioration in business fundamentals.

By targeting out-of-favour stocks, the contrarian approach takes time to deliver. Contra funds suit patient, risk-tolerant investors with an investment horizon of more than five years. They are suited as a satellite allocation within a diversified portfolio. All the three funds in the category managed to deliver better returns over long run. They could meaningfully enhance portfolio diversification and long-term return potential despite the occasional risk of value traps.

ALERTS.

SBI MF launches Nifty G-sec Jul 2031 Index Fund

SBI Mutual Fund (MF) has launched SBI Nifty G-Sec July 2031 Index Fund, an open-ended Target Maturity Index Fund predominantly investing in constituents of Nifty G-Sec July 2031 Index with relatively-high interest rate risk and relatively-low credit risk. The NFO closes on May 19. The entry load is not applicable and exit load is nil for the scheme. The minimum subscription amount is ₹5,000 and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter. The performance of the scheme will be benchmarked against Nifty G-Sec July 2031 Index and its fund manager is Rajeev Radhakrishnan.



Groww MF launches Nifty Private Bank ETF

Groww Mutual Fund has launched Groww Nifty Private Bank ETF, an open-ended scheme tracking the Nifty Private Bank Index - TRI. The NFO closes on May 20, 2026. The entry load is not applicable and exit load is nil for the scheme. The minimum subscription amount is ₹500 and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter. The performance of the scheme will be benchmarked with Nifty Private Bank Index TRI and its fund managers are Nikhil Satam, Aakash Chauhan and Shashi Kumar.



ETF movers

ETF	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
	as on May 15			
Angel One Silver ETF	10.1	10.1	5.8	7,721
360 One Silver ETF	261.1	260.8	5.1	499
Zerodha Silver ETF	27.0	26.6	4.5	140,121
Mirae Asset Silver ETF	258.5	255.3	4.4	4,392
Edelweiss Silver ETF	265.0	261.3	4.3	526
Aditya Birla SL Silver ETF	265.2	261.0	4.2	16,827
Bandhan Silver ETF	265.4	261.2	4.2	382
Mirae Asset Gold ETF	152.7	152.1	4.3	19,692
Quantum Gold Fund	130.2	129.7	4.2	787
Kotak Gold ETF	131.1	130.7	4.2	17,985

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on May 15, 2026

Best NPS plans

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on May 15	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	52.6	12.3	12.6	13.8	76,458
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.1	13.7	13.5	13.5	28,177
Kotak Pension Fund	65.4	12.8	13.2	13.4	4,533
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	30.5	6.1	5.7	8.3	8,645
SBI Pension Fund	40.9	6.1	5.7	7.7	28,714
HDFC Pension Fund	28.0	5.8	5.4	7.6	51,638
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.0	7.5	6.7	8.2	33,770
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.2	7.3	6.5	8.0	13,416
SBI Pension Fund	45.4	7.3	6.4	8.0	15,231
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	45.5	12.4	12.6	13.8	1,834
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	56.9	13.4	13.5	13.6	791
Kotak Pension Fund	57.5	12.8	13.2	13.3	220

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on May 15, 2026

Active equity mutual funds cut their cash cushion

DRY POWDER. Lower cash buffers suggest higher market participation, but also reduced flexibility to seize buying opportunities during market corrections

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

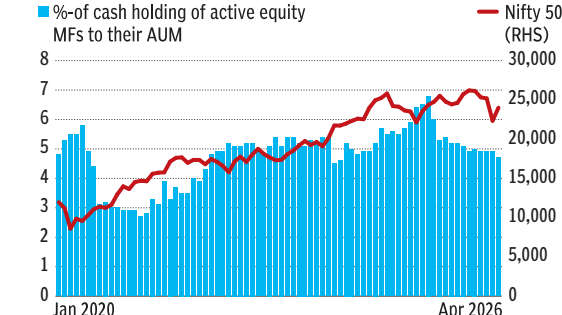
Active equity mutual funds have sharply cut their cash buffers over the past year. Cash holdings fell from ₹3 lakh crore in April 2025 to ₹1.68 lakh crore in April 2026, while cash as a share of active equity fund AUM declined from 6.8 per cent to 4.7 per cent. This matters because cash levels offer a useful, though sometimes imperfect, signal of fund managers' risk appetite, valuation comfort and market positioning.

bl.portfolio analysed the cash holdings of 577 actively-managed equity-oriented schemes, including diversified, sectoral and thematic funds, between April 2025 and April 2026. This was done to understand how managers positioned portfolios amid volatile market conditions, including the US tariff shock, West Asia conflict-related risk and uneven market performance across large-, mid- and small-cap segments.

Sustained retail flows have provided steady liquidity, with SIP (systematic investment plan) inflows averaging nearly ₹29,500 crore a month over the last one year. For market context, in the one-year period ended May 15,

Active equity funds cut cash buffers

Trend in overall active equity MF universe



Source: ACEMF Cash holdings of 577 actively managed equity-oriented schemes between April 2025 and April 2026 analysed *percentage point

2026, the Nifty 50 TRI (includes dividends) declined 4.5 per cent. In contrast, the Nifty Midcap 150 TRI gained 8 per cent, the Nifty Smallcap 250 TRI rose 4 per cent and the Nifty Microcap 250 TRI advanced 2 per cent.

BUFFERS SHRINK

The nearly 2 percentage point decline in cash as a share of active equity fund AUM marks a clear reversal from April 2025, when cash levels were at a six-year high.

Elevated cash holdings usually coincide with market uncertainty, rich valuations or heavy inflows awaiting deployment.

The April 2025 spike likely reflected caution after a strong mar-

ket run and valuation concerns.

The subsequent fall in both absolute cash and cash as a share of AUM suggests that funds deployed part of their liquidity buffers. This could be either due to improving conviction or the need to reduce cash drag, where uninvested money hurts returns when markets rise.

Among diversified equity categories, mid-cap, small-cap, flexi-cap and value funds saw significant reductions in cash holdings over the year. Contra funds also saw a steep fall while the technology and pharma & healthcare funds increased cash buffers. This divergence suggests greater caution in sectors exposed to global

demand, currency movements, regulatory risks or valuation uncertainty.

BIGGIES CUT CASH

The trend was visible even among schemes with assets exceeding ₹50,000 crore. Nine of the 11 large schemes saw cash levels decline over the past year.

For large schemes, cash management is also shaped by liquidity considerations, as deploying or exiting large positions can be harder, especially outside the most liquid large-cap names. Therefore, lower cash levels may signal greater willingness to participate in the market, but also the pressure on funds to avoid

Active equity categories

Category	Cash holding as of Apr 2025 (%)	Cash holding as of Apr 2026 (%)	PP* change over past year
Technology Funds	2.7	6.2	3.5
Pharma & Health Care	1.7	2.3	0.6
Large & Mid Cap	3.1	3.4	0.3
Large Cap Funds	5.1	3.8	-1.4
Multi Cap Funds	4.7	2.6	-2.0
Small cap Funds	8.5	6.2	-2.3
Consumption Funds	4.7	2.2	-2.5
Flexi Cap Funds	9.2	6.7	-2.6
Mid Cap Funds	7.2	3.7	-3.5
Contra Funds	15.3	10.7	-4.6

Funds with larger corpus (₹50,000 cr and above)

Scheme	Cash holding as of Apr 2026 (%)	PP* change over past year	Corpus as of Apr 2026 (₹ cr)
Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	15.1	-8.7	1,40,950
HDFC Flexi Cap	4.9	-5.7	1,00,479
HDFC Mid Cap	6.6	-0.9	94,745
ICICI Pru Large Cap	6.0	-3.2	75,650
Nippon India Small Cap	2.9	-2.4	72,673
Kotak Midcap	0.8	-3.7	63,539
ICICI Pru Value	6.3	-5.0	59,588
Kotak Flexicap	2.7	0.8	54,839
SBI Large Cap	2.8	-4.0	53,468
Nippon India Multi Cap	0.4	-2.7	52,634
Nippon India Large Cap	3.6	0.6	51,690

Funds that reduced cash significantly

Scheme	Cash holding as of Apr 2025 (%)	Cash holding as of Apr 2026 (%)	PP* change over past year
Motilal Oswal Midcap	32.1	4.0	-28.1
Motilal Oswal Multi Cap	21.4	5.0	-16.4
Sundaram Business Cycle	16.9	0.8	-16.1
Parag Parikh ELSS Tax Saver	19.3	4.4	-14.9
DSP Banking & Financial Services	18.8	4.8	-14.0
HSBC Financial Services	17.4	3.8	-13.6
Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	15.4	2.0	-13.4
Taurus Ethical	13.9	1.8	-12.1
ICICI Pru Quant	14.0	4.0	-10.0
ICICI Pru Rural Opportunities	14.3	5.0	-9.3
ICICI Pru Housing Opp	11.0	2.0	-9.0

duced cash levels over the year, Motilal Oswal Midcap cut its cash allocation from over 32 per cent to just 4 per cent.

The broader point is that many active managers appear to have cut cash drag, especially as mid- and small-cap segments delivered positive returns despite large-cap weakness.

TAKEAWAYS

For investors, lower cash is a two-sided signal. It helps funds participate better when markets recover, but leaves them with less ready money to buy stocks during corrections.

Cash levels should not be read mechanically. High cash may re-

flect valuation discipline, recent inflows or liquidity management. Low cash may reflect conviction, cash-drag concerns or the need to stay close to benchmarks.

Unutilised cash is not idle. It is usually parked in TREPS (Tri-Party Repo) and other short-term instruments, so that funds still earn some return while waiting to invest.

TREPS annualised yields have ranged between 3.1 per cent and 7 per cent over the last five years.

Cash levels are therefore useful, but not decisive. They must be read with the fund's mandate, valuation style, flows, market-cap exposure and long-term performance.

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Our previous call on food and agri-business major Godrej Agrovet was published in March 2024, when the stock was around ₹485. The stock is now around ₹570, giving a moderate price gain of about 17.5 per cent (annual dividend yield of about 2 per cent) but outperforming broader market by over 15 percentage points.

However, the journey hasn't been linear. The stock hit all-time high of ₹877.85 (BSE) in July 2024, corrected a bit, again moved near peaks in July 2025, and then has corrected 35 per cent so far. We believe the rallies were driven by a mix of Godrej family settlement-led ownership clarity, recovery expectations after a weak FY23 (profit drop), improving margins and hopes around palm oil and animal nutrition businesses, while the correction from peak can be attributed to the uneven delivery across Crop Care, Dairy and Astec, along with the possible reassessment of near-term earnings expectations.

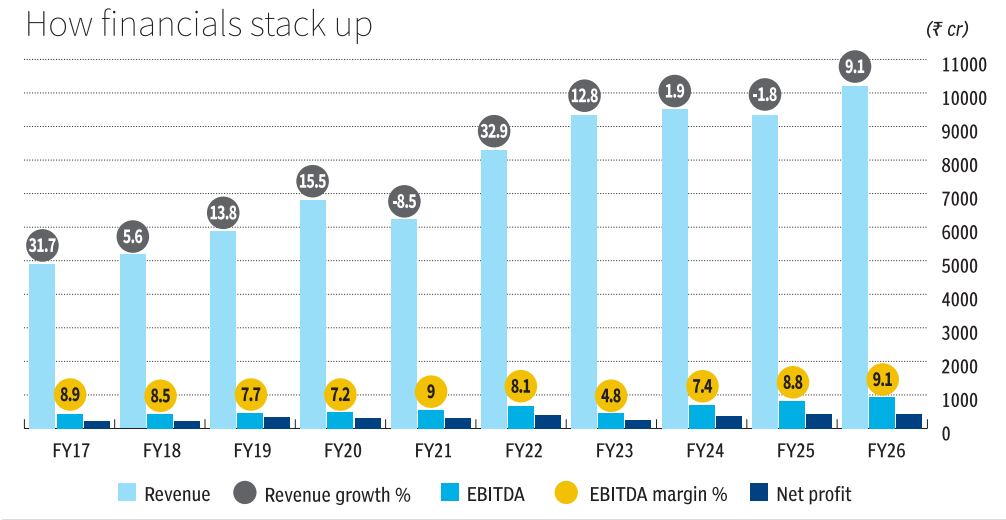
The stock now trades at around 17 times FY28-estimated consensus earnings, which assume about 18 per cent adjusted EPS growth in both FY27 and FY28, following a 7.6 per cent rise in FY26. Valuation comfort comes from the fact that the FY27 PE is about 16 per cent below its five-year average, while earnings growth over the next two years supports the medium-term upside.

Thus, existing investors can continue to hold Godrej Agrovet shares. Fresh investors with a three-five year view can accumulate gradually, on declines. The business case now rests on earnings delivery, not just re-rating. FY26 shows clear improvement, but the recovery is uneven. Palm oil and animal nutrition are strong engines. Crop care, dairy, foods and Astec businesses need to step up more.

BUSINESS

Godrej Agrovet has multiple business segments, each with different pulls and plugs.

One, it sells cattle, poultry, fish and shrimp feed in India and Bangladesh under various brands. Two, it produces crude palm oil (CPO), crude palm kernel oil (CPKO) and palm kernel cake in a domestic plantation-



Revenue, EBITDA and Net Profit are on adjusted basis *FY26 numbers are excluding non-recurring & exceptional items Source: Bloomberg

led integrated model. Three, the company sells herbicides, insecticides, fungicides etc. under its crop care segment. Astec, a listed subsidiary (m-cap ₹1,500 crore), makes active chemical ingredients and intermediates. Four, it runs the Jersey dairy brand through Creamline. Five, it also sells poultry/processed foods under Real Good Chicken and Yummiez.

Segment wise, the company organises operations across animal nutrition (46 per cent revenues in FY26), palm oil (19 per cent), dairy (15 per cent), crop care (11 per cent), poultry/processed foods (7 per cent) and others. But as percentage of FY26 consolidated segment profit before interest and taxes, Palm oil is the biggest, followed by animal nutrition, crop care, poultry/processed foods, dairy and others.

● **ACCUMULATE ON DIPS**

Godrej Agrovet ₹570.10

WHY

- Palm oil & animal nutrition driving PAT rise
- Crop care, dairy, Astec need recovery
- Sustained operational improvement visible

Specifically in FY26, animal nutrition and palm oil performed well, but crop care business faced a challenging year. Astec segment achieved a turnaround, reaching EBITDA break-even. Dairy segment profitability was squeezed by elev-

ated milk procurement costs. Foods saw revenue degrowth but saw margin uptick. Beyond profitability, Godrej Agrovet saw improvement in operational efficiency as average net working capital days fell from 45 in FY24, 39 in FY25 to 25 in FY26. Average ROCE has improved to 20 per cent in FY26.

GROWTH PILLARS

The main change is that Godrej Agrovet is no longer only a margin recovery story. Consensus estimates project 9-9.5 per cent margin for FY27 and FY28, not very different from FY26. The company is trying to become a more focused, value-added and market-facing agri platform. Let us look at its two big segments.

Palm oil segment had a landmark FY26. Segment revenue rose 42.4 per cent and segment result (segment profit before in-

On the road to recovery

CHEMICALS. SRF has navigated recent challenges well, as reflected in its latest Q4FY26 results

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

SRF reported its Q4FY26 results in early May and provided a strong outlook. We had recommended a hold on the stock in August 2025 because valuations were elevated at 44 times one-year forward earnings even when factoring for expectations of strong growth. Since that call, the stock has declined 4 per cent, even though the company delivered 7 per cent year-on-year revenue growth to ₹15,787 crore and 44 per cent PAT growth to ₹1,835 crore in FY26. Valuations have now moderated to 36 times one-year forward earnings, broadly in line with the five-year average. We now recommend that investors accumulate the stock on market corrections linked to the US-Iran conflict.

Two of SRF's three large segments—speciality chemicals and performance films—are expected to recover over the longer term. The company has navigated recent challenges well, as reflected in its latest results. However, volatility in energy costs and global trade remains an overhang for both the company and the broader economy.

As shown in the chart, the largest segment of chemicals delivered strong revenue and EBIT growth in FY26. Even as the performance films segment reported weak revenue growth, the revival in margins aided strong profit growth. The company is expected to see similar trends in the next fiscal too.

CHEMICALS BUSINESS

The division includes speciality chemicals and refrigerant gas (RG) business. The management expects to drive 15-20 per cent revenue growth in FY27 for the Chemicals segment, which should be primarily supported by the RG sub-segment. This is on the base of a 16 per cent growth in FY26 for chemicals.

The year gone by witnessed

● **ACCUMULATE ON DIPS**

SRF Ltd ₹2,688.65

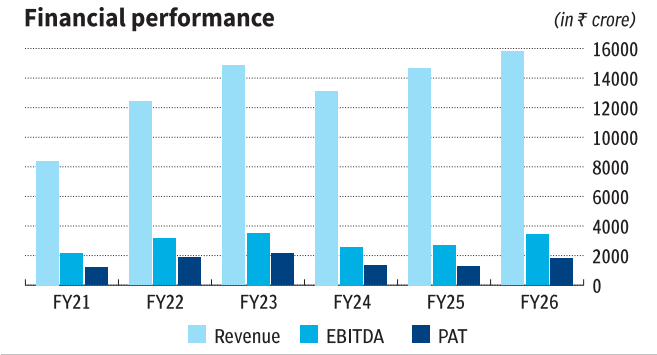
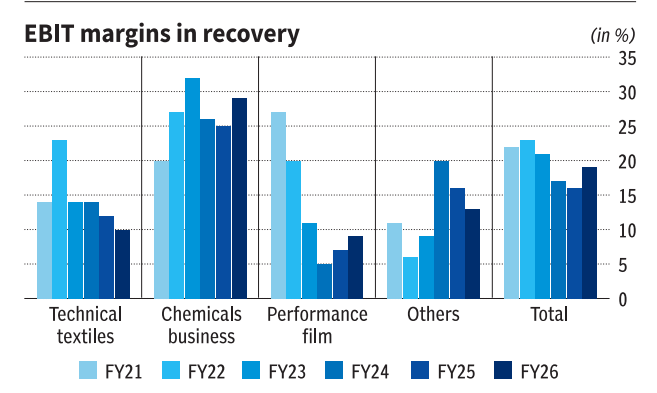
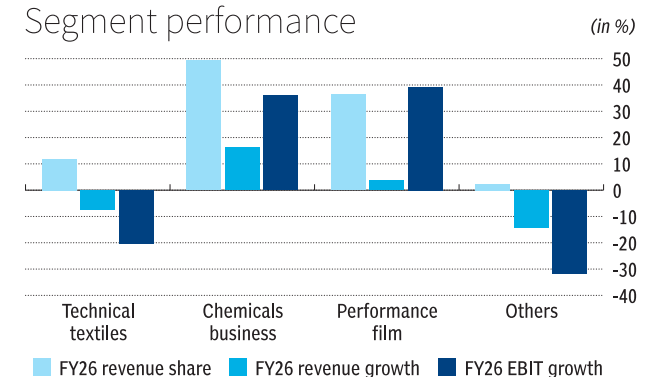
WHY

- Valuations have normalised
- Strong capital expansion plans
- Margin recovery underway

strong volume and price growth for RG. Internationally, RG sales are now under a quota regime to limit the impact of greenhouse gases. This appears to have benefited existing companies in the business with elevated volumes and better price realisations. The company should gain further, as it debottlenecks its facilities, secures volumes and continues to be supported by improved prices. It expects to add 10-15 per cent volume by debottlenecking for a total volume of 65,000 tonnes per annum in capacity.

SRF is building a facility for RG, developed from in-house research, which is a fourth-generation RG and is likely to be environmentally sustainable. The plant is expected to be commercialised by February 2028. The project includes annual RG capacity of 20,000 tonnes and a 30,000-tonne hydrofluoric acid (a raw material) facility to support production, while also offering potential to explore electronic-grade sales.

The company has entered into a strategic collaboration with Chemours (the US-based chemicals major that was spun off from Dupont) for the manufacture, supply and distribution of fluoropolymers and fluoroelastomers. The multi-year arrangement caters to global markets across diverse industries such as semiconductor, automotive, aerospace, chemical processing, and oil and gas. The company has allotted a capital outlay of ₹745 crore for



the project that will be completed by December 2026 and should contribute to revenues towards Q4FY27.

It has also started trial production of higher grades of fluoropolymer - PTFE, which should also contribute to sales this fiscal.

On the other hand, the speciality chemicals sub-segment under the Chemicals segment has been facing lower volume in demand and pricing pressure on account of Chinese competition

in the last two-three years. This is similar to performance films and technical textiles division as well.

To counter the same, SRF has developed a pipeline of advanced intermediates in agro chemicals division, which are under client evaluation. It will utilise new launches even as the old portfolio is expected to face increasing competition. The recent quarter indicates an easing of pricing pressure, as the speciality chemicals cycle may be im-

terest and taxes) rose 67.9 per cent. Segment margin improved to 20.1 per cent from 17 per cent. The management commentary indicates record area expansion, strong fresh fruit bunch growth, record oil extraction ratio and a medium-term benefit from tree maturity. It has developed over 75,000 hectares of plantations across Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Goa, Maharashtra and Mizoram. The company is also moving towards value-added products, with a speciality fat refinery being rolled out and a goal to have 50-55 per cent of the palm oil portfolio in value-added products by FY31.

Animal nutrition business has also improved. FY26 volumes grew 11.6 per cent and Q4 volumes rose 15.2 per cent. Cattle feed was the key driver, with Q4 volumes up 24 per cent. The management is targeting double-digit FY27 revenue growth, largely volume-driven. Growth will be driven by new products and higher adoption of branded compound cattle feed. There is also new pet-food manufacturing adjacency.

OUR VIEW

The positives are clear. First, palm oil has become a high-margin profit engine with multi-year volume visibility from maturing trees and downstream value-addition. Second, animal nutrition is showing volume growth, mix improvement and margin support from branded feed adoption. Third, working capital and ROCE improvement give the business better quality. Net debt to EBITDA at around 2x is comfortable.

The checks are equally important. Crop care had a weak FY26, with steep drop in margins. The management expects recovery from Q2FY27, but this remains to be seen. The recovery could face near-term headwinds from higher costs due to global supply disruptions. Creamline Dairy also remains weak, with FY26 revenue flat and EBITDA falling by one-third. Astec has improved, but not yet a meaningful profit engine. Lastly, India's 2026 monsoon will be a key monitorable, given Godrej Agrovet's exposure to crop inputs, cattle feed, dairy costs and palm oil yields. Globally, palm oil prices remain exposed to Malaysia/Indonesia supply, crude-linked biodiesel demand and weather risks.

proving, but the timing of recovery is yet unknown. SRF is also developing a pharma intermediates platform, under which several early-stage intermediates are under sales, and the company aims to develop a larger, more advanced portfolio, supplementing agro chemicals.

It expects a capital expenditure of ₹2,500 crore in FY27, which includes facilities supporting chemicals division. SRF has acquired land in Odisha, where a greenfield plant will be developed. Supported by pharma intermediates and agro chemical launches in speciality chemicals, fourth-generation RG launch, Chemours project and PTFE advanced-grade launches, SRF expects to drive 15-20 per cent revenue growth for chemicals in FY27.

PF DIVISION

As stated, performance films and technical textiles divisions are also facing Chinese competition. But the performance films (manufactures packaging films) division is showing improved margins, as pricing pressure eases. The segment reported 220-bp improved EBIT margins in FY26, which is likely to continue. SRF is conducting trial runs for a higher-grade performance film plant and adding a new production line for a higher-grade film in FY27. This should further support margin recovery and also revenues if the pressure eases.

The company has a comfortable net debt to EBITDA of 1.29 times in March 2026, which supports the strong capital expansion the company has undertaken for FY27. SRF has reported only a minor impact from the US-Iran-Israel conflict: disruption in RG sales to West Asian countries, which it has redirected through other routes. But considering the energy volatility, raw material sourcing from China and trade disruption, we recommend investors accumulate the stock on dips with an eye on longer-term recovery.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

GLOBAL BOARDROOM CHATTER.

What they say on their India plans

With India being the fastest growing large economy, 'what is your India plan?' is a common topic in boardrooms of most global corporations. One important source to distil their India plans is from their quarterly earnings calls. With the March quarter earnings season in progress, this column will present what CXOs of global corporations are saying about India, along with their perspectives and plans during the current earnings season. Here are some from companies that reported their earnings last week.

Siemens Aktiengesellschaft (SIE, m-cap €210.25 billion)

The German industrial giant highlighted India as a key manufacturing and engineering hub for its global rail operations. "We have ramped up production of components, bogies and drive systems in India, with the first locally-manufactured locomotives already in operation. India now provides Siemens with strong supply-chain visibility and a globally-scalable manufacturing base."

Eutelsat Communications S.A. (ETL, €3.56 billion)

The satellite communications provider is expanding its India-linked maritime connectivity business while awaiting regulatory approvals for broader broadband services. "Eutelsat signed an expanded multi-year agreement with India's Station Satcom to scale LEO connectivity services for maritime customers. While broader broadband approvals are still pending in India, the company continues to grow its India-related business activities."

CIE Automotive, S.A. (CIE, €3.43 billion)

The Spanish auto components maker said India continues to stand out as one of the strongest global automotive growth markets. "India's automotive market is showing broad-based structural growth, with passenger vehicles up 9 per cent, two-wheelers over 20 per cent, tractors above 30 per cent and trucks over 25 per cent. Despite high acquisition valuations, we continue to see strong long-term growth opportunities in the market."

ICL Group (ICL, ILS24.25 billion)

The speciality minerals and agricultural solutions company expanded its India operations with a new speciality water-soluble fertilizer manufacturing facility. "ICL opened its first speciality fertilizer production facility in India with 30,000 metric tonnes of annual capacity, strengthening local manufacturing capabilities, supporting growing market demand and improving supply chain resilience."

Cambi ASA (CAMBI, Nkr3.38 billion)

The Norwegian wastewater treatment technology company highlighted India as a key manufacturing and infrastructure growth market for its future competitiveness. "India is essential to maintaining cost competitiveness, while wastewater infrastructure opportunities are expanding beyond Mumbai into additional cities. The Mumbai plants will be critical in supporting future growth in the country"

Gilat Satellite Networks (GILT, \$1.22 billion)

The satellite communications technology company identified India as a major growth market within its Asia-Pacific expansion strategy through a new partnership with Nelco. "Gilat announced a multi-million-dollar partnership in India to deploy SkyEdge IV for the country's first Ka-band service rollout using the JSAT-N2 HTS satellite. India is a central growth market, with the deployment supporting high-performance connectivity across aviation, cellular backhaul and enterprise services."

Contributed by **NAFA** ASSET MANAGERS

How sectoral indices moved				
	May 8	May 15	Movement	% change
METALS	42,744	43,386	▲	1.5
HEALTHCARE	46,535	47,193	▲	1.4
FMCG	18,998	18,826	▼	-0.9
TECK	14,937	14,647	▼	-1.9
OIL&GAS	27,414	26,834	▼	-2.1
BANKEX	62,354	60,489	▼	-3.0
PSU	21,838	21,176	▼	-3.0
POWER	8,285	7,968	▼	-3.8
CONSUMER DURABLES	60,554	58,163	▼	-3.9
CAPITAL GOODS	80,125	76,826	▼	-4.1
AUTO	59,963	57,425	▼	-4.2
IT	28,585	26,964	▼	-5.7
REALTY	6,410	5,909	▼	-7.8

How other indices moved				
NIFTY 200	13,921	13,596	▼	-2.3
NIFTY 100	25,169	24,572	▼	-2.4
NIFTY 500	23,116	22,531	▼	-2.5
BANK NIFTY	55,311	53,710	▼	-2.9
NIFTY NEXT 50	71,496	69,280	▼	-3.1

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 My chairman is a first-generation entrepreneur who began his career as a professional and advised his clients to acquire control of me.
- 2 Even after recently completing 50 years on the board, he remains executive chairman. He became a billionaire just after Covid, in 2020.
- 3 Though I have been around for over eight decades, my revenue crossed \$1 billion only in the trailing 12 months.
- 4 I have delivered over 20 per cent CAGR to shareholders over the past decade, despite just 10 per cent annual sales growth and lower RoE than the industry standard.
- 5 Institutional ownership is now higher than the promoter stake, as some of my promoters have been selling shares.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by **UNIFI CAPITAL**
Last week's stock: Vadial Industries
Last week's winner: Premnand Bhat

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,644) and Nifty Bank (53,710) lost 2.2 per cent and 2.9 per cent, respectively, over the past week. The derivatives data indicates that the market sentiment has weakened over the past week, although the degree of bearishness varies between Nifty and Bank Nifty.

At the broader level, traders continue to hold net short positions on both calls and puts, showing that option writers remain dominant. However, the sharp rise in net call shorts (FII and retail combined), from 59,438 contracts to 1.94 lakh contracts, along with a decline in net put shorts, from 3.58 lakh contracts to 2.93 lakh contracts, suggests that traders are increasingly capping upside expectations while becoming less aggressive in defending downside levels.

This deterioration in options positioning aligns with the futures data. Cumulative futures open interest increased in both Nifty and Bank Nifty while prices declined, indicating fresh short build-up at the index level.

That said, there is a divergence between the two indices.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures, both May and June contracts, dropped 2.4 per cent each. But while Nifty May futures Open Interest (OI) remained broadly unchanged at 170 lakh contracts over the last week, June futures OI increased from 18.4 lakh contracts to 33.5 lakh contracts, denoting short build-up.

With respect to options, PCR (Put Call Ratio) of May series dipped from 1.10 to 1.02 and that of June series saw a minor drop from 1.3 to 1.2. Despite the drop in the ratio, it has not slipped below 1, suggesting that option



traders are not aggressively bearish yet. Overall, there has been a build-up in short positions in futures, but positioning in options suggests that bearish conviction could still be moderate.

Looking at the chart of Nifty May futures, we can see clear rejection at 24,500 area over the past few weeks. On the back of this, the contract falling last week shows that the sellers are now gaining confidence and creating fresh short positions.

Although 23,500 is the nearest support for Nifty May futures (currently at 23,644), we anticipate a decline below this given the above factors. The potential up-

- POSSIBILITIES**
- F&O positioning favours the bears
 - Recovery attempts may face resistance
 - Traders can consider short positions

coming downswing can drag Nifty futures to 23,000. It could even extend to 22,600.

For Nifty futures to fully shed the bearishness, it should see a strong breakout of 24,750. Nevertheless, given the current chart

structure, a rally above 24,000 is unlikely to happen.

Strategy: Short Nifty futures (May) at 23,800. Target and stop-loss can be 23,000 and 24,150, respectively.

Option traders can consider buying June expiry 23,000-put (₹306.60). Go long at ₹250. Target and stop-loss can be ₹650 and ₹95, respectively.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures, both May and June contracts, fell 3 per cent each. However, OI of the former decreased from 23.2 lakh contracts to 21.8 lakh contracts whereas that of the latter increased from nearly 3 lakh contracts to 5.2 lakh contracts. This hints that traders have already started rolling over short positions from May to June expiry, indicating prolonged weakness.

In the options segment, both May and June PCR dropped, particularly June PCR which slipped from 1.15 to 0.74. This indicates significant call writing, a bearish signal. Overall, the derivatives data suggests stronger bearish conviction in Nifty Bank when compared to Nifty 50.

After falling below the support band of 54,500-55,000, Nifty Bank May futures has been sustaining below it. Even if there is an uptick from the current level of 53,842, a recovery beyond 55,000 is a big ask given the prevailing price action and how futures and options traders have positioned themselves.

Nifty Bank May futures is likely to see another leg southwards, potentially to 51,000.

Strategy: Go short on Nifty Bank futures (May) at 54,700. Target and stop-loss can be 51,500 and 56,000, respectively.

Option traders can buy June expiry 52,000-put contract (₹772.35). Buy at ₹600. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,200 and ₹300, respectively.

ment. The argument is based on the delta of options and futures. Futures prices move one-to-one with the underlying whereas option prices cannot. So, the more confident you are of your view, the more you should lean towards futures. That said, you must be mindful of two factors. One, even though the maximum loss on a long option position is only the premium paid, you could lose a significant part of this premium if the Nifty Index moves adversely. And two, if you are a disciplined trader, you could choose to trade futures with strict stop-loss.

OPTIONAL READING
You must observe trends in implied volatilities (Ivols) of the immediate out-of-the-money (OTM) strike. This could give you an indication of how rich options currently are. If current Ivol is greater than in the recent past, the option is pricey, as higher volatility leads to greater premium. This means larger losses on the long option position, as Ivol is part of an option's time value, which decays with each passing day. In such cases, futures may be optimal.

The author offers training programs for individuals to manage their personal investments

Nifty or individual stocks?

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

The market has been on a roller coaster ride recently because of geopolitical issues. A directional bet on a stock is typically risky in such market conditions. Nevertheless, you must take directional bets if you want to capture short-term gains from trading. This week, we look at why, during such market conditions, it is more optimal to take directional bets on the Nifty Index than on individual stocks or even a sectoral index.

REWARD-RISK TRADE-OFF
The advantage with an index is that it is a weighted average of a basket of stocks. That means even if some stocks fall and others rise, the index could still move in your preferred direction. This is better than betting on an underlying. What if the underlying declines or remains flat even as the market or the sector to which the underlying belongs to climbs up? By betting on an index rather than a stock during non-trending (volatile) markets, you can improve the odds of your position generating gains.

The above argument typically holds whether you are betting on a style index or a sectoral index. But if you were to factor the cur-



- **EXPLOSIVE**
- Mid-cap index and sectoral indices are typically more volatile than the large-cap index

rent market conditions, your strategy may have to be further refined. Mid-cap index and sectoral indices are typically more volatile than the large-cap index when systematic risk increases. Note that geo-political issues increase systematic risk. Also, the

Nifty Index constitutes over half of the total market capitalisation. Therefore, an increase or decrease in systematic risk directly impacts Nifty Index. So, when nervousness among market participants reduces, the Nifty Index typically leads the market up. Therefore, betting on the Nifty Index could be more meaningful than betting on the mid-cap index or any sector indices.

Should you consider options or futures on the Nifty Index to take directional bets? Your choice must depend on your conviction on the directional move-

Bears to take control

BULLION CUES. Traders can go for fresh shorts

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Prices of precious metals dropped last week in the international market. Gold (\$4,540.70/ounce) and silver (\$76/ounce) were down 3.7 per cent and 5.4 per cent, respectively.

However, in the domestic market, there was an uptick in price due to the rise in import customs duty. Gold futures (₹1,58,547/10 gm) was up 3.9 per cent and silver futures (₹2,71,886/kg) gained 3.8 per cent. Below is our analysis.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,58,547)
Gold futures (June) broke out of the resistance at ₹1,55,000 and marked a two-month high of ₹1,64,497 last Wednesday. But then the price moderated to close the week at ₹1,58,547.

The breakout is unlikely to sustain, given the weakness in gold in the global market. We expect gold futures to see a decline to ₹1,48,500. A breach of this can lead to a fall to ₹1,40,000.

But in case there is a rally, it is likely to be capped at ₹1,63,000.



Trade strategy: Short gold futures (June) at ₹1,58,550. Place stop-loss at ₹1,65,000. When the price drops to ₹1,53,000, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,55,000. Book profits at ₹1,48,500.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,71,886)
Silver futures (July) broke out of the resistance at ₹2,63,000 early last week. It touched a two-month high of ₹3,04,891 on Wednesday, before seeing a correction in the subsequent sessions.

The breakout in silver futures, too, might not sustain. From the current level, we expect it to fall to ₹2,50,000 in the near term. The next support is at ₹2,40,000.

Trade strategy: Short silver futures, if it inches up to ₹2,85,000 for a better risk-reward ratio. Initial stop-loss can be ₹3,05,000. Exit at ₹2,50,000.

Set to break out

CRUDE CHECK. Participants can buy futures

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices surged last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$109.30/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹9,685/barrel) were up 7.9 per cent and 10.9 per cent, respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$109.30)
Brent crude oil futures found support in early May showed signs of bulls gaining traction. In line with this, the contract saw a considerable rise last week.

The price remains above both 21- and 50-day moving averages and the daily chart shows that Brent crude futures has formed a higher base last week at around \$100 compared to the base at \$94 made in April. The price action maintains a positive inclination and the probability of further rally is high.

We expect Brent crude futures to break out of \$115 and soon touch \$125. In case there is a decline, it will most likely be arrested at \$94.



MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹9,685)
Crude oil futures (June), in the first week of May, saw good buying interest on the back of the support at ₹8,400, which coincided with the 21-day moving average.

A rebound last week and the formation of a higher low adds strength to the bulls' case.

There is a good chance for crude oil futures to surpass the barrier at ₹9,800 and rally to ₹11,000.

If there is a decline from the current level, the contract can find support at ₹9,000. Below this, is the support band of ₹8,200-8,400.

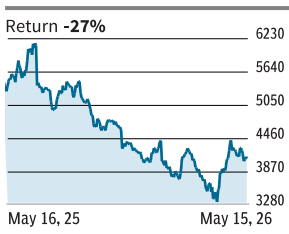
Trade strategy: Buy crude oil futures if the price dips to ₹9,200 to achieve a better risk-reward ratio. Target and stop-loss can be ₹11,000 and ₹8,200.

F & O QUERY



AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Can I short Trent futures at current market price?
Saravanan Na



Trent (₹4,101.30): The stock has been in a steady downtrend since October 2024. But since early April, the price has been on the rise. It posted a gain of nearly 26 per cent last month. However, this is likely to be only a

corrective rally, as the resistance at ₹4,470 holds well. The 23.6 per cent Fibonacci retracement level of the downtrend coincides at ₹4,470, making it a significant barrier.

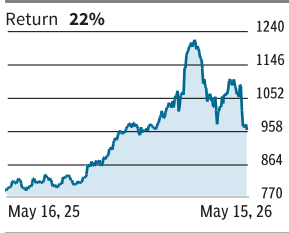
For Trent futures (May) (₹4,105.90), the resistance is at ₹4,500. That said, the price action shows that the contract has a support ahead at ₹4,000.

Given that the overall trend is bearish and that the corrective rally is capped by a barrier, there is a good chance for Trent futures to breach the support at ₹4,000 and drop to ₹3,500 in the near term.

If you have high risk tolerance, you can short Trent futures now at ₹4,105 and place stop-loss at ₹4,550. When the contract slips to ₹3,750, revise the stop-loss to ₹3,900. Book profits at ₹3,500.

For safe play, short Trent futures after it breaks down below the support at ₹4,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹3,500 and ₹4,250, respectively.

I'm holding long position on June expiry SBIN 1000-call. Suggest me target and stop-loss levels.
A K Suriya



SBIN (₹963.20): After witnessing a sharp downtrend, the stock has been consolidating over the past few sessions. While this indicates that the bear trend is losing momentum, the nearest notable support is at ₹945.

There could be further

decline before a recovery, if any. Even if there is a bullish reversal, only a clear breakout of ₹985 will indicate a sustainable rally.

So, we suggest exiting the call option. You may go long once the stock breaks out of ₹985. In this case the price can see a surge to ₹1,020 and ₹1,040.

✉ Send your queries to derivatives@thehindu.co.in.

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on May 15	Weekly change %	As on May 15	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	35826	3	259336	10
Future Index Short	252333	3	100614	16
Net Futures	-216507	3	158722	6
Index Call options Long	532822	13	2921368	-1
Index Call options Short	789341	9	2858972	3
Net Call options	-256519	3	62396	-67
Index Put options Long	904311	11	2446899	14
Index Put options Short	513070	19	3130948	9
Net Put Options	391241	1	-684049	-8

FII's have marginally increased net short on index futures and index call options. They've also slightly increased net long on index put options. These are bearish indications.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on May 15)				
KAYNES	3,271.90	-27.4	143.2	186.6
MUTHOOTFIN	3,311.40	-6.2	121.9	93.3
CIPLA	1,432.10	6.3	361.3	55.3
SOLARINDS	17,314.00	7.5	14.5	41.4
KALYANKJIL	353.05	-16.8	806.5	36.6
FALL (as on May 15)				
PIDILITIND	1,467.70	-0.6	145.4	-20.9
BSE	4,000.60	2.4	235.5	-11.7
KOTAKBANK	387.05	1.6	2599.4	-9.1
SHREECEM	24,970.00	-1.8	5.5	-9.0
SAIL	192.40	4.1	2038.4	-8.5

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on May 18)

KAYNES	SAIL
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Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on May 15)				
ALUMINIUM	29-May	378.9 (2.8)	2,953 (-5)	Short covering
COPPER	29-May	1,341.6 (1.3)	9,612 (-13)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	18-Jun	9,685.0 (10.9)	9,994 (108)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	18-Jun	9,686.0 (10.9)	30,474 (118)	Long build-up
GOLD	5-Jun	1,58,547.0 (3.9)	7,227 (-21)	Short covering
GOLDGUINEA	29-May	1,27,401.0 (3.8)	8,215 (-45)	Short covering
GOLDM	5-Jun	1,58,153.0 (3.7)	39,236 (-11)	Short covering
GOLDPETAL	29-May	15,958.0 (3.7)	98,263 (-48)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	29-May	1,58,404.0 (3.7)	18,746 (-42)	Short covering
LEAD	29-May	202.3 (0.9)	185 (-37)	Short covering
NATURALGAS	26-May	284.0 (8.8)	23,790 (-21)	Short covering
SILVER	3-Jul	2,71,886.0 (3.8)	8,247 (21)	Long build-up
SILVERM	30-Jun	2,74,837.0 (4.0)	17,767 (-3)	Short covering
SILVERMIC	30-Jun	2,74,831.0 (4.0)	48,721 (-7)	Short covering
ZINC	29-May	363.2 (4.3)	2,146 (8)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on May 15)				
USDINR	26-May	95.78 (1.3)	25,00,543 (60)	Long build-up
EURINR	26-May	111.86 (0.4)	28,494 (0)	Short covering
GBPINR	26-May	128.30 (-0.3)	32,050 (-5)	Long unwinding
JPYINR	26-May	60.57 (0.2)	403 (0)	-

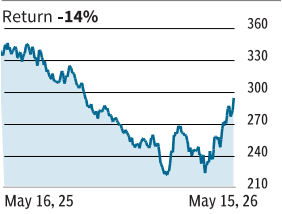
F&O Strategy

Buy Crompton Greaves

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals (₹301.95) is ruling at a crucial level. Immediate resistances are at ₹333 and ₹401. A close above the latter will change even the long-term outlook positive for the stock.

Nearest support levels are at ₹282 and ₹255. A close below the latter can drag the stock to sub-₹200 level. But in the near-term, we expect the stock to continue in the recovery path.



F&O pointers: May futures of Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals (expiring on May 26) closed at ₹302.10 and June futures closed at ₹303.95 against the spot price of ₹301.95. The negligible premium indicates that traders are still cautious on the stock. Option trading indicates that the stock could move in the ₹280-320 range.

Strategy: Going long on Crompton Greaves futures is quite risky and the margin obligation is high. Hence, risk-averse traders can avoid this trade. While the initial stop-loss can be at ₹293, that can be shifted to ₹300 if the stock opens on a positive note. The stop-loss can be shifted to ₹305, if the contract moves above ₹310.

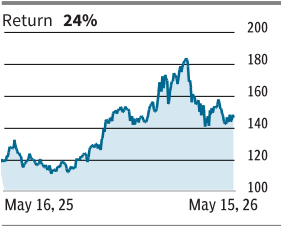
Traders can aim for ₹333. Stop-loss should be handled deftly so that profits and capital are protected. This is not applicable if the stock opens above ₹308 or below ₹295.

Short Take

Bank of India F&O adjustments

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

On May 12, Bank of India (₹142.26) (BoI) announced an interim dividend of ₹4.65. The face value per equity share is ₹10. This will lead to adjustments in the futures and options (F&O) contracts on this stock on the record date. The company has decided on May 29 as the record/effective date, when the stock price and all derivatives contracts on BoI will be adjusted accordingly.



With respect to adjustment in futures contracts, the reference rate of the relevant contract on May 27 (as May 28 is a market holiday) will be considered. Reference rate will be the mark-to-market settlement price of the relevant futures contract. So, the open positions shall be carried forward to May 29 at the daily settlement price on May 27 minus ₹4.65, the dividend amount.

Suppose the June expiry futures closes at ₹140 on May 27, it will be revised to ₹135.35 (₹140 minus ₹4.65). Hence, the contract value will come down.

Likewise, in options, all the strike prices in the option chain of BoI will be subtracted by ₹4.65 from May 29. For example, the strike price of 140 and 150 will be modified to 135.35 and 145.35, respectively.

That said, the above measures are unlikely to impact the overall trend of this stock. Traders can stick to their views and are required to note the changes in the contracts that they hold.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and the Nifty Bank index fell over 2 per cent each last week. We had expected the Sensex and Nifty to make a bullish breakout of their range and rise. This view has gone wrong. The fall last week has turned the short-term picture slightly negative. The benchmark indices have to rise immediately and breach their near-term resistance. Only then can they get some relief. Failure to do so will keep them vulnerable to fall more in the short term.

FPIS SELL

Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) continue to sell Indian equities. They shed about \$1.34 billion last week. There has been a net outflow of about \$2.84 billion so far this month.

NIFTY 50 (23,643.50)

Short-term view: Key resistance is in the 23,900-24,100 region. As long as Nifty stays below this resistance, the bias will remain negative. A break below 23,600 can trigger a fresh fall to 23,100-23,000 initially. A further break below 23,000 will then increase the danger of touching 22,400.

To avoid this fall, Nifty has to sustain above 23,600 and breach 24,100. Only then it can get some relief and rise to 24,700.

Medium-term view: The fall last week has not disrupted the big picture. For now, the broad 22,000-26,500 range is intact from a medium-term perspective.

We retain our bullish bias on the Nifty to break above 26,500 eventually. Such a break can take it up to 28,000-30,000 in the long term.

Nifty has to decline below 22,000 to prove our bullish view wrong. Only then the outlook will turn bearish, and the downside will open up for a fall to 21,000-20,000.

NIFTY BANK (53,710.35)

Short-term view: Contrary to our expectation, Nifty Bank index declined below 53,700. However, it has managed to bounce back from the low of 53,191.60.

Important resistance is at 55,500. If the index breaches this hurdle, a rise to 57,500-58,000 is possible.

But failure to rise above 55,500 from here can be bearish, and can drag Nifty Bank index to 52,500 or even 50,000.



INDEX OUTLOOK. Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index have room to fall more before reversing higher

NEAR-TERM RESISTANCE

- Nifty 50: 24,100
- Sensex: 77,000
- Nifty Bank: 55,500

Medium-term view: The broader picture remains positive. We retain the bullish view of seeing a rise to 64,000-65,000 in the medium term. A rise above 60,500 can clear the way for this rise. The fall last week is going to delay this rally.

From a long-term perspective, Nifty Bank index can target 68,000-69,000 on the upside.

Our bullish view will come under threat only if the index declines below 50,000. If that happens, a fall to 49,000-48,000 and even lower levels can be seen.

SENSEX (75,237.99)

Short-term view: Against our expectation, Sensex declined below 76,000 last week. This has turned the short-term outlook negative. There is room for a fall to 72,900-72,700. Thereafter, we see good chances for a rise back to 76,000 and higher.

The region around 77,000 will be an important resistance now. Sensex has to rise past this resistance to turn the outlook positive and revisit 78,000 and higher levels.

Medium-term view: For

Nifty 50: Reversing lower



now, the broad 71,000-86,000 range is intact.

As long as the Sensex stays above 71,000, the bias will remain positive to get a bullish breakout above 86,000. Such a break can take the Sensex higher to 90,000 initially. It will also keep the upside open to target 94,000 over the long term.

Our bullish view will go wrong only if the Sensex declines below 71,000. In that case, 69,000 and lower levels can be seen.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150

(22,257.95)

Nifty Midcap 150 index fell sharply in the first half of the week and made a low of 21,899.20. But, it bounced back well recovering some of the loss.

The near-term outlook is slightly negative.

Failure to get a strong follow-through rise from here can drag it down to 21,700-21,600. However, a fall beyond 21,600 is unlikely.

We can expect the Nifty Midcap 150 index to sustain above 21,600 and rise back to 22,500 again. Broadly, for now, 21,600-23,100 can be the trading range. The bias remains positive. As such, we retain our view of getting a bullish breakout above 23,100 eventually. Such a break can take the Nifty Midcap 150 index up to 26,000-26,500 initially and then to 28,000-28,500 eventually in the long term.

The big picture will turn negative only if the index declines below 20,800.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250

(16,722.90)

The rise to 17,700 did not happen. On the contrary, the index tumbled over 4 per cent giving back all the gains made in the previous week.

Support is in the 16,500-16,450 region. We expect the index to sustain above this support zone and bounce back. A rise above 17,000 will take the Nifty Midcap 250 index up to 17,600-17,700 in the short term.

The big picture has not changed. Our bullish view still remains intact. Crucial resistance is at 18,300. A break above it can boost the momentum. It will then clear the way for a rally to 22,500-23,000 and even 24,000 in the coming months.

The Nifty Midcap 250 index has to decline below 14,000 to turn the outlook bearish. But that looks unlikely in the absence of any new negative trigger.

bl.portfolio
video

Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English



Tamil

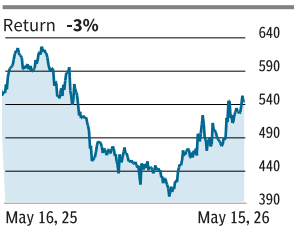


MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Balrampur Chini Mills (₹541.25)

Steady uptrend

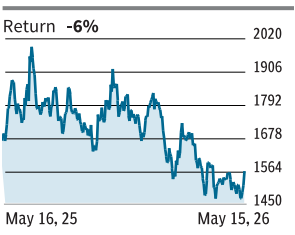


The stock of Balrampur Chini Mills has been in a steady uptrend since early February. The bulls capitalised on the support at ₹400 and turned the tide in their favour. Three weeks back, the scrip rose past the important level of ₹500, the 50-week moving average, indicating a strong upside momentum. The support at ₹500 is expected to hold, and the stock is likely to appreciate to ₹660 in the near term.

Hence, traders can consider buying the stock of Balrampur Chini Mills now at ₹541 and accumulate at ₹500. Place initial stop-loss at ₹490. When the scrip rallies to ₹590, raise the stop-loss to ₹550. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹600 when the stock hits ₹630. Book profits at ₹660.

Bharti Hexacom (₹1,563.40)

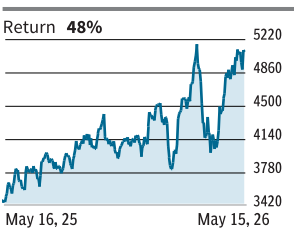
Potential shift in trend



For about two months now, Bharti Hexacom stock has been in a sideways crawl. It has been oscillating between ₹1,450 and ₹1,620. Although the scrip has remained within this price band, it has rebounded from the base at ₹1,450 thrice during the period of consolidation, the latest being last week. This indicates that the stock is undergoing a potential shift in trend. We anticipate the breakout of ₹1,620 soon, which will open the door for an upswing to ₹1,800. So, one can go long now at ₹1,563 and buy more shares at ₹1,480. An initial stop-loss can be at ₹1,420. When the stock rises to ₹1,680 and ₹1,750, alter the stop-loss to ₹1,580 and ₹1,700, respectively. Exit at ₹1,800.

KEI Industries (₹5,117.20)

Support holds strong



The stock of KEI Industries broke out of a barrier at ₹4,750 a month ago. While it has not seen a strong follow-through rise, the price action shows good buying interest around the resistance-turned-support level of ₹4,750. We expect the stock to eventually gain more traction and establish a fresh leg of uptrend, which can lift KEI Industries' stock to ₹6,150 over the medium term. Therefore, participants can consider buying the stock now at ₹5,117 and accumulate at ₹4,800. Place stop-loss at ₹4,500. When the price hits ₹5,600, alter the stop-loss to ₹5,200. Trail the stop-loss further higher to ₹5,600 when the stock touches ₹5,900. Liquidate the longs at ₹6,150.

Gaining momentum

Gurumurthy K

bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index have closed higher for the week in spite of the sharp fall on Friday. The real action was seen in the currency and bond space. The dollar index rose about 1.5 per cent recovering almost all the loss made in the previous two weeks. The US 10 Year Treasury Yield on the other hand surged 24 basis points (bps) last week.

On the charts, the rise in the dollar index and the Treasury Yield last week strengthens the bullish case. This could slow down the pace of rise in the US equities. Although there is room for the benchmark indices to move higher from here, a cautious approach would be needed. That is, we may have to start looking at the equity markets from the sell side rather than the buy on dips approach.

DOW JONES (49,530.94)

The sideways range remains intact at 48,700-50,200. We will have to wait for a breakout of either side of this range to get clarity on the next move. For now, the broader uptrend is intact. So, a bullish breakout above 50,200 and a rise to 51,300-51,500 is still a possibility. In case the index breaks below 48,700, then a fall to 46,000-45,000 can be seen. It is a wait and watch situation now.

S&P 500 (7,408.49)

The index has come off after making a high of 7,517.12. Failure to rise back immediately can trigger a corrective fall to 7,330 or even 7,250 in the short term.

A bounce from around 7,250 will keep the broader uptrend intact and take the S&P 500 index up to 7,500 again. It will also keep the upside open to see 7,600 and 7,750.



US MARKET OUTLOOK.
\$ and Treasury yields surge;
bourses stay stable

CRUCIAL RESISTANCE

The dollar index can rise to 100.50-101 on a break above 99.45

The uptrend will come under threat only if the index declines below 7,250. If that happens, then 7,130-7,100 can be seen on the downside.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE

(26,225.14)

The resistance in the 26,700-26,750 mentioned last week has held very well. The NASDAQ Composite index has come down after touching a high of 26,707.14.

A fall below 26,000 from here will indicate that a top is in place. That in turn can trigger a fall to 25,750 or even 25,300 in the coming weeks. Such a fall will then keep the downside open to see 24,000 going forward.

To avoid this fall, the NASDAQ Composite index has to sustain above 26,000 and rise past 26,750. If it manages to do this, then 27,200 can be seen on the upside.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The rise last week indicates that the dollar index (99.27) is gaining momentum. Immediate resistance is at 99.45. A break above it will be very bullish. Such a break can take the dollar index higher to 100.50-101 in the short term.

Failure to rise above 99.45 can drag the index down to 98.50-98 again. In that case, 97.50-99.50 can be the trading range for some time.

The price action around 99.45 will need a close watch this week.

TREASURY YIELD

The rise to 4.6 per cent on the US 10 Year Treasury Yield (4.6 per cent) has happened much quicker than expected. Immediate support is around 4.55 per cent. If the yield manages to sustain above this support and gets a good follow-through rise, the upmove can gain further strength. That will have the potential to take the 10 Year Yield higher to 5 per cent in the coming months.

A fall below 4.55 per cent is needed to pause the rise and drag the yield down to 4.45-4.4 per cent.

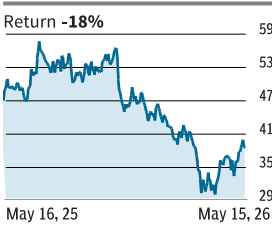
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl.research bureau

I bought shares of Medi Assist Healthcare Services at ₹345. Can I buy more? What is the outlook?

Renuka Choudhary, Patna

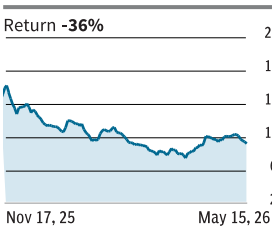


Medi Assist (₹387): The broader trend is down. But the recent bounce from the low of ₹293.40 made in March is giving some relief. The stock can rise to ₹450 and even ₹490 in the next three-four months. Immediate

supports are at ₹378 and ₹360. Keep a stop-loss at ₹350 and hold the stock. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹390 and ₹430 when the share price goes up to ₹425 and ₹465, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹485. Failure to breach ₹490 and a reversal will indicate that the broader downtrend is intact. Then there is a danger of the price falling back to ₹380. So, make sure to exit the stock at ₹485.

I bought Allcargo Logistics recently at ₹9.16. What is the long-term outlook?

Devang

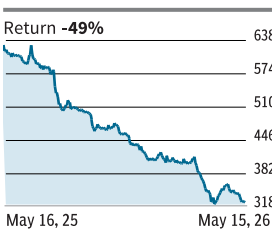


Allcargo Logistics (₹8.80): The stock is in a strong downtrend since January 2024. The stock can fall to test the long-term support level of ₹5 in the next two-three months. A strong bounce from around ₹5 and a

subsequent rise above ₹15 will be bullish from a long-term perspective. That will have the potential to take the share price up to ₹30 over the next three years. If you have the patience and the risk appetite, then keep a stop-loss at ₹3.20 and hold the stock. Buy more on dips at ₹6. Move the stop-loss up to ₹8 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹13. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹15 and ₹22 when the share price touches ₹19 and ₹26, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹29.

I have bought Sanofi India shares at ₹4,897. What is the long-term outlook?

Govindaraju, Chennai

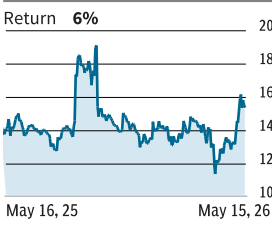


Sanofi India (₹3,222): The stock has tumbled over 50 per cent from its peak of ₹7,593.60 made in September 2024. There is still room to fall more. The stock can test ₹2,900-₹2,800. A bounce thereafter can trigger a corrective rise to

₹4,000-₹4,100. A sustained rise above ₹4,100 is needed to indicate a bullish trend reversal. Such a rise may need some strong positive trigger. The chances of seeing a consolidation between ₹2,800 and ₹4,100 also cannot be ruled out. It is better to accept the loss and exit the stock now. We always insist in this column to have a stop-loss at the first place whenever entering a trade and strictly adhere to it. That will help in minimising the loss and avoid getting stuck in a wrong position.

I have Hemisphere Properties India shares. My purchase price is ₹133. What is the outlook?

Niranjana, Mangalore



Hemisphere Properties India (₹149): The price action since the stock got listed in October 2020 is in the form of a bull channel. The recent bounce from the low of ₹111 made in March is happening from the lower end of

this channel. The outlook is bullish. The share price can go up to ₹260 — the upper end of the channel in the next one year. Keep the stop-loss at ₹105 and hold the stock. Buy more at ₹132 if you get a dip. Move the stop-loss up to ₹180 when the stock goes up to ₹205. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹220 when the price goes up to ₹240. Exit the stock at ₹260.

Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all!" So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

- Vodafone Idea
- Solar Industries
- Tata Consumer Products
- Berger Paints
- Rainbow Children's Medicare

Last week's prize winner
Quresha Khatoon

Last week's winning stock
Motilal Oswal Financial Services

Closing price (May 08)
₹882.70

Closing price (May 15)
₹842.70

Return:
-4.53 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 2.7 and 2.2 per cent respectively last week. BSE Metal gained the most by 1.5 per cent, followed by BSE Healthcare 1.4 per cent. BSE Realty and BSE IT declined by 7.8 and 5.7 per cent respectively last week.

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Y-High	Y-Low
360 ONE [1]	10931.29	29.9	36.5	4.5	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.9	-2.0	14.3	0.0	22.730	906.2
3M India [2]	31272.3	542.7	57.6	16.4	202604	0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-2.5	39.8	0.0	38380.0	28390.0
A B B [2]	6382.4	71.9	88.8	17.3	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	-8.9	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5
A B Lifestyle [2]	103.8	1.7	60.7	9.0	202603	11.9	57.7	7.2	29.4	-9.0	11.7	2.3	176.1	87.7
A B Real Estate [2]	1291.4	-27.0	3.9	202603	-79.1	-878.4	-66.4	-605.4	-13.3	-0.2	10.3	0.0	2535.0	1080.1
Aadhar Hsg. Fin. [2]	462.8	25.8	18.2	2.7	202603	18.2	27.0	18.2	21.5	-7.7	11.4	2.8	547.8	42.4
Aarti Industries [2]	112.9	1.0	112.9	1.0	202603	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
AAVAS Financials [2]	1382.3	61.9	22.3	2.9	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	-4.3	9.9	3.2	2152.0	1050.3
Abbott India [2]	27934.6	730.4	38.2	12.4	202603	6.5	7.6	8.1	9.7	4.8	5.0	0.0	35921.6	2514.0
ACC [2]	1364.4	112.4	12.1	1.3	202603	16.9	62.9	17.3	-9.0	-2.0	17.9	0.0	2027.8	1260.0
ACME Solv Hold. [2]	276.3	8.3	33.3	3.3	202603	1.0	40.0	87.6	-2.3	-0.3	16.8	0.0	324.3	35.0
Action Consq.Eng. [2]	888.7	35.5	25.0	5.9	202512	-2.3	4.2	0.3	8.6	-6.0	40.2	0.0	1390.0	746.1
Adani Energy Sol [2]	1306.9	19.0	68.8	6.2	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	-3.5	10.1	2.2	1463.0	74.5
Adani Enterpr. [1]	2715.9	16.7	162.4	4.4	202603	20.3	-124.0	26.6	-48.0	8.4	9.0	1.8	2800.0	1753.5
Adani Green [2]	1378.1	11.2	122.9	11.4	202603	28.7	40.5	22.3	8.1	-1.9	14.0	0.0	1472.3	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1795.7	20.3	89.9	6.0	202603	26.5	11.4	17.1	14.0	-1.0	14.0	0.0	1823.8	1291.0
Adani Power [2]	221.3	6.7	33.2	6.6	202603	-0.1	52.3	-3.5	-0.8	-1.7	21.2	0.7	234.4	105.7
Adani Total Gas [1]	615.7	6.0	103.3	13.9	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	-2.8	17.4	0.4	797.4	45.3
Aditya Birla Cap [2]	1029.6	33.8	30.5	7.4	202603	9.9	18.0	9.5	5.0	-4.1	35.5	0.0	1122.8	677.0
Aditya Birla F&S [2]	62.7	15.2	4.1	1.2	202512	1.9	215.9	9.7	4.5	-0.5	0.0	1.3	77.7	53.6
Aditya Birla Cap [2]	357.2	14.5	24.6	2.7	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	-1.6	9.5	4.4	375.9	212.5
Aegis Logistics [2]	674.6	21.9	30.8	4.0	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	-6.6	14.5	0.9	946.5	576.0
Aether Industri. [2]	1111.6	17.0	65.2	6.0	202603	27.0	48	38.3	35.3	-8.4	9.7	0.1	1274.2	723.2
Affle 3+ [2]	1386.5	23.9	24.2	1.6	202603	-13.3	5.7	56.1	-4.9	-3.1	24.5	0.0	2593.1	285.0
Affco [2]	1477.3	32.3	45.7	5.7	202603	20.3	16.0	19.5	19.1	-2.0	16.6	0.1	2186.8	1251.9
Alia Engineering [2]	3853.0	124.8	30.9	4.9	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	-3.0	19.1	0.1	4200.0	3006.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3147.7	84.5	37.6	8.8	202603	21.5	18.4	17.3	14.7	-4.7	32.0	0.0	3300.0	2335.0
Alkerm Pharma [2]	784.7	31.7	25.2	2.8	202603	16.4	36.2	13.4	30.2	-1.2	14.2	0.0	1117.8	43.4
Alkem Lab [2]	4548.5	200.9	27.3	4.9	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.0	-1.6	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4716.8
Alkyl Amines [2]	1723.0	35.2	49.0	5.8	202603	0.2	-1.4	-2.3	-3.3	-0.9	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1212.4
Allied Blenders [2]	555.6	8.2	67.5	9.4	202603	9.4	-48.1	11.4	18.2	-6.1	21.0	0.9	720.0	377.7
Alloy Industries [2]	113.8	1.6	41.9	4.2	202603	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	-21.4	1.0	0.0	2.5	1.1
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	824.1	37.4	22.0	2.0	202512	4.2	-22.2	5.1	-26.8	-7.3	15.6	0.0	1095.9	671.5
Amber Enterpr. [2]	8471.7	57.2	148.2	8.2	202603	10.5	-26.8	22.2	-17.3	-4.0	13.5	0.8	8970.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	433.8	20.0	21.6	1.8	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.5	-2.4	12.7	0.0	725.0	394.0
Amar Pathi Wea. [5]	3584.8	47.7	75.2	2.8	202603	28.7	40.5	22.3	3.1	-0.7	56.8	0.1	3733.9	1763.7
Anant Raj [2]	488.2	15.4	31.7	3.0	202603	19.6	23.6	21.9	30.4	-13.0	19.0	0.1	641.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	306.5	10.0	30.5	4.6	202603	38.2	83.5	-1.9	-21.9	-6.0	25.8	0.7	335.0	208.9
Apur Inds. [2]	12644.6	246.9	51.2	10.5	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	-1.3	32.6	0.1	13101.0	6800.0
Apollu Tubes [2]	1208.7	15.2	81.9	6.4	202603	1.0	20.9	5.7	58.9	-1.0	13.6	0.2	2300.0	393.0
Apollo Hospitals [5]	1086.1	126.3	64.0	12.8	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	-0.2	17.5	0.6	8250.0	6680.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	394.4	33.6	11.7	1.5	202603	14.2	254.7	9.0	72.5	-3.6	10.9	0.3	540.3	392.3
Aptus Value Hou. [2]	264.8	18.8	14.1	2.6	202603	18.7	26.5	25.5	-6.4	15.1	1.5	364.9	193.5	
Ashia India Glas [2]	620.1	12.3	66.7	5.7	202603	6.4	32.8	5.8	4.7	-1.9	13.1	0.9	1073.0	688.0
Ashok Leyland [2]	134.2	1.6	84.2	1.6	202512	23.6	36.2	13.4	30.1	-9.2	14.9	4.3	215.4	115.0
Asian Paints [2]	2605.5	42.6	61.2	12.8	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	0.2	24.4	0.1	2985.5	2116.9
Aster DM Health. [2]	753.8	7.8	96.9	9.2	202603	18.2	39.7	12.2	17.6	-1.5	21.6	0.5	770.0	519.8
Astral [2]	120.9	1.0	120.9	1.0	202603	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Astramarec Phar [2]	8488.5	83.2	102.0	26.6	202512	38.9	-42.3	34.5	24.1	0.0	32.9	0.0	10551.5	7630.0
Ather Energy [1]	93.7	-13.4	14.0	202603	73	-142.8	62.8	36.9	2.4	0.0	1.1	989.4	301.7	
Atul [2]	7999.1	230.3	30.8	3.4	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	0.2	12.8	0.0	7793.0	5663.0
AU Small Finance [2]	901.1	35.3	28.1	3.8	202603	17.5	65.2	16.0	25.4	-5.6	0.0	0.0	7793.0	5663.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1511.3	60.8	24.9	2.5	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	-0.7	-1.5	12.6	0.2	1824.0	810.0
Aurum Invest [1]	507.7	42.8	11.9	2.7	202512	-22.5	-70.2	-16.0	-9.5	-2.5	29.7	0.1	683.5	400.0
Avenue Super. [2]	4358.0	45.5	95.7	11.6	202603	18.9	19.2	15.9	9.7	-0.8	14.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7
AVL Agri Busine. [1]	199.9	8.2	24.5	2.5	202603	17.7	53.5	17.3	13.4	-3.3	19.8	0.3	285.4	174.3
Axis Bank [2]	1244.9	84.9	14.7	1.8	202603	5.3	1.7	4.1	-6.0	-1.9	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1011.2

BHEL [2]	398.2	4.6	86.6	5.3	202603	36.9	155.8	19.2	199.7	-1.6	3.2	0.4	417.7	205.2
B PCL [2]	294.4	57.6	4.9	7.5	202612	5.2	90.0	0.5	78.3	-6.1	15.7	0.7	391.9	766.9
Bajaj Auto [2]	10378.1	385.4	26.9	7.5	202603	40.2	101.6	22.6	47.1	-3.1	28.1	3.8	10789.9	7879.5
Bajaj Finance [1]	910.3	30.8	29.5	5.0	202603	18.4	22.0	19.4	15.4	-4.7	11.4	0.1	210.5	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [2]	17274.8	62.9	27.5	3.6	202603	6.3	5.0	13.2	13.4	-4.9	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings [2]	184.5	4.6	41.6	1.2	202603	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Bajaj Housing [2]	83.8	3.1	27.2	3.1	202603	15.7	14.1	16.6	18.8	-4.2	9.5	4.7	128.5	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2147.3	64.3	33.4	3.8	202603	6.6	-18.7	3.6	-24.9	-5.1	17.9	0.3	620.0	2016.0
Balarampur Chini [1]	541.3	18.7	28.9	2.8	202603	6.7	30.4	15.8	13.4	3.5	11.1	0.6	287.0	33.4
Banque Bank [2]	684.5	1.6	25.6	1.2	202603	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Bank of Baroda [2]	261.5	3.8	6.8	0.8	202603	5.2	7.0	4.6	-4.2	-1.0	0.0	0.0	325.6	230.6
Bank of India [2]	142.2	23.5	6.1	0.8	202603	5.9	18.7	6.0	11.9	1.8	0.0	0.0	178.5	109.0
Bank of Maha [2]	78.0	9.1	8.6	1.9	202603	15.2	36.1	17.4	26.6	-6.9	0.0	0.0	85.9	50.1
Banque Bank [2]	3846.7	43.5	45.7	4.4	202512	6.3	0.9	1.9	-39.7	-4.7	17.9	0.1	541.8	2986.8
Bata India [2]	149.9	14.9	9.5	202512	2.8	9.0	0.6	-23.4	0.6	1.9	0.0	190.0	605.6	
Bayer Crop Sci. [2]	4350.3	149.2	29.2	6.3	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	-5.6	23.8	0.0	4540.0	4276.1
BEML Ltd. [2]	1787.6	29.9	59.8	5.3	202512	23.7	-191.7	8.4	-4.8	-8.3	11.7	0.1	2474.1	1361.9
Berger Paints [2]	533.2	10.0	53.3	5.0	202603	6.1	17.3	1.9	-1.2	3.3	34.8	0.1	604.6	391.5
Bharat Dynamics [1]	1282.1	15.2	84.9	11.5	202512	31.4	50.4	57.2	2.5	-8.3	10.2	0.0	2096.0	1090.0
Bharat Electron [1]	423.6	8.2	51.9	14.4	202512	24.0	20.5	14.5	19.5	-3.7	26.9	0.0	73.3	340.6
Bharat Forge [2]	1913.4	24.6	77.9	9.6	202603	17.5	2.1	11.2	13.8	-3.8	11.7	0.9	2043.0	1390.0
Bharti Airtel [5]	1904.6	48.2	39.5	7.8	202603	15.7	-12.0	22.0	10.1	3.8	14.3	2.2	2174.7	1745.0
Bharat Petroleum [2]	1281.1	14.1	44.5	1.9	202603	15.4	1.4	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Bikaji Foods [5]	1563.4	35.1	44.5	10.2	202603	5.4	-11.1	9.4	35.6	4.4	16.5	1.5	2051.0	1438.6
Bikaji Foods [1]	669.7	10.0	67.3	11.2	202512	11.2	117.6	13.9	-8.3	-0.3	18.4	0.2	820.9	591.6
Biocon [5]	430.1	3.8	112.7	21.1	202603	2.9	-61.6	11.5	-35.4	13.0	6.9	0.8	434.5	37.8
Birla Corp. [2]	1023.6	72.9	14.0	1.2	202603	0.8	-3.6	4.8	72.9	-2.8	7.2	0.6	1537.2	73.5
Birla Corporation [2]	314.6	17.2	81.9	4.3	202603	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
BLS Internat. [2]	253.1	15.6	16.2	4.9	202512	4.3	34.8	47.6	41.9	-12.6	39.0	0.1	421.9	218.5
Blue Bird Express [1]	5060.3	119.9	42.2	6.8	202603	6.2	-11.3	7.4	12.7	-10.9	17.1	0.7	722.4	468.9
Blue Bird Group [2]	4.5	30.0	0.9	25.0	202603	20.9	20.6	25.4	20.6	25.4	20.6	25.4	20.6	25.4
Blue Star [2]	1658.1	27.0	61.5	9.9	202603	1.3	10.4	3.6	14.7	-1.2	-25.8	0.1	2050.0	1450.0
Bosch [2]	37698.1	783.8	48.1	7.9	202512	9.4	7.9	11.3	-4.2	-1.2	20.5	0.0	41494.9	28650.0
Brannabes Solut. [2]	224.4	-3.0	25.2	202512	11.6	72.0	12.3	-3.4	-4.9	0.0	4.3	438.7	207.0	
Brannabes Solut. [2]	224.4	-3.0	25.2	202512	11.6	72.0	12.3	-3.4	-4.9	0.0	4.3	438.7	207.0	
Britannia Inds [1]	5405.0	105.2	51.4	25.5	202603	7.1	21.1	7.5	15.3	-2.1	51.9	0.4	6337.0	5280.0



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	59.4	16542	1.4	0.5	-5.3	11.3	11.1	13.5	0.35
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	105.6	75650	1.7	1.2	-3.4	14.2	14.2	14.1	0.49
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	87.3	51690	1.2	0.6	-1.8	14.5	16.3	14.7	0.56
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1081.5	38121	1.6	1.0	-4.5	11.5	13.1	13.1	0.44
*****	JM Large Cap	147.0	422	2.8	1.3	-2.1	12.5	12.1	11.1	0.36
*****	Kotak Large Cap	545.6	10599	1.7	0.7	-3.8	11.7	11.8	12.4	0.37
*****	SBI Large Cap	90.6	53468	1.5	0.8	-0.7	10.9	12.0	12.1	0.39
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	497.6	28970	1.4	0.8	-4.5	11.6	12.0	12.0	0.38
***	Bandhan Large Cap	74.7	2007	1.8	0.8	-0.9	13.3	12.6	12.7	0.38
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	214.5	2579	1.7	0.7	-1.7	13.2	12.8	12.5	0.40
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	80.0	1439	2.1	0.7	-3.9	11.1	11.7	12.5	0.36
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	970.1	7236	2.2	1.6	-4.3	11.0	9.6	10.7	0.31
***	Invesco India Largecap	67.0	1722	1.8	0.7	-1.4	14.3	13.5	12.7	0.40
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	107.0	38239	1.3	0.5	-3.6	9.7	10.4	12.9	0.32
***	Tata Large Cap	490.0	2688	2.0	1.0	-1.5	11.9	12.2	12.0	0.38
***	UTI Large Cap	256.0	12053	1.9	1.2	-5.9	9.4	9.6	11.5	0.28
**	DSP Large Cap	450.2	7192	1.8	0.9	-4.7	13.7	11.9	11.6	0.39
**	HSBC Large Cap	454.1	1784	1.8	1.0	-2.6	11.5	11.2	12.1	0.32
**	LIC MF Large Cap	51.7	1352	2.2	1.1	-7.2	8.3	8.9	10.3	0.24
**	Union Largecap	22.5	439	2.1	1.3	-3.4	9.9	10.5	-	0.31
**	Axis Large Cap	56.9	30498	1.3	0.6	-5.6	9.1	8.0	11.6	0.21
*	Groww Largecap	41.4	128	2.5	1.3	-0.9	11.1	11.0	11.0	0.31
*	PGIM India Large Cap	319.6	544	2.4	0.9	-5.5	7.9	8.3	10.2	0.23
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.5	701	2.3	0.7	-6.7	10.6	10.2	-	0.31
-	Taurus Large Cap	154.0	51	2.4	2.2	-0.5	13.1	11.6	10.5	0.34

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	137.6	16672	1.4	0.4	6.7	22.3	19.0	16.2	0.59
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	330.1	28255	1.6	0.9	0.0	16.8	17.1	14.9	0.54
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	989.3	29757	2.0	1.2	0.2	18.0	18.4	15.8	0.66
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	32.8	15582	1.4	0.5	3.8	16.7	14.7	-	0.41
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	119.3	3249	2.0	0.7	4.1	17.9	16.3	15.8	0.45
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	625.8	38426	1.7	1.0	4.3	15.5	16.1	14.9	0.54
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	179.9	5986	1.9	1.0	3.0	19.3	17.0	14.4	0.56
*****	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	89.6	468	2.1	1.0	5.1	15.8	14.5	12.9	0.43
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	242.5	24675	1.4	0.5	-3.5	13.6	13.3	14.9	0.40
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	599.9	17331	1.7	0.7	-1.6	17.1	14.5	15.1	0.47
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	86.6	4531	1.9	0.5	2.9	16.4	15.0	14.8	0.46
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	99.1	9761	1.5	0.5	4.8	22.5	18.1	16.1	0.49
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	335.8	30251	1.6	0.6	1.6	15.9	15.5	15.4	0.47
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	149.8	42338	1.3	0.5	3.3	15.1	13.3	16.9	0.39
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1445.5	7081	1.5	1.0	0.8	18.2	16.6	13.4	0.51
***	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	181.6	3399	2.8	2.2	-2.0	13.8	12.7	11.5	0.39
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	37.0	2958	2.0	0.9	-2.4	15.4	13.8	14.3	0.41
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	83.6	6575	1.8	0.8	0.9	14.1	14.2	14.2	0.41
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	477.5	7802	1.8	0.7	-7.3	8.9	11.6	12.5	0.35
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	892.7	5648	1.6	0.9	1.8	13.2	10.5	11.8	0.26
*	Navi Large & Midcap	34.8	300	2.1	0.5	0.0	11.1	12.3	12.5	0.35
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	27.9	4877	1.6	0.7	9.2	19.5	16.5	-	0.40

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1936.1	100479	1.4	0.7	-1.1	17.8	18.5	16.3	0.68
*****	JM Flexicap	93.7	5041	2.6	1.4	-3.5	17.9	17.4	16.6	0.50
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	87.7	140950	1.1	0.5	0.1	16.1	15.7	17.1	0.59
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	32.7	3320	1.9	0.5	1.5	16.1	14.9	14.8	0.44
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1539.7	19049	1.7	1.0	-5.5	14.7	14.6	13.3	0.46
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.0	5793	1.8	0.5	-1.2	10.4	10.3	13.9	0.30
*****	Union Flexi Cap	49.4	2294	1.7	0.8	-1.1	12.8	12.9	13.1	0.38
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1824.9	25632	1.4	0.7	3.6	16.7	13.5	14.2	0.41
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	203.4	7285	1.5	0.9	-0.7	13.8	12.6	11.0	0.38
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	328.1	13083	1.5	0.5	-0.9	12.4	12.2	14.1	0.37
***	DSP Flexi Cap	98.5	11769	1.7	0.7	-2.6	13.8	12.1	14.2	0.34
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	219.1	5405	1.6	0.9	3.1	17.6	15.5	13.2	0.42
***	Kotak Flexicap	82.7	54839	1.4	0.6	-0.3	13.9	13.0	13.8	0.39
***	SBI Flexicap	105.1	22403	2.3	1.5	-1.6	10.0	10.6	12.1	0.32
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.4	3633	1.9	0.6	-2.0	13.7	11.9	-	0.36
**	Axis Flexi Cap	25.7	12546	1.5	0.5	-1.4	12.8	10.6	-	0.28
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	55.3	12770	1.9	1.1	-7.8	18.1	12.3	12.2	0.33
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.2	260	2.1	0.5	5.2	11.8	12.0	-	0.36
**	UTI Flexi Cap	293.9	22168	1.6	1.0	-8.0	7.8	6.9	11.5	0.15
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	95.4	973	2.4	1.7	3.9	11.6	11.0	10.2	0.30
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.1	128	2.1	0.7	-2.2	8.6	9.1	-	0.22
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	216.8	344	2.7	2.6	-2.0	12.2	11.2	9.9	0.32
-	Quant Flexi Cap	103.2	6594	2.0	0.8	6.5	17.9	17.2	19.2	0.50

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	284.5	3219	1.7	0.8	2.8	16.8	16.4	14.6	0.45
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	822.9	16997	1.7	0.9	5.7	19.4	17.6	15.2	0.58
-	Invesco India Multicap	121.8	3995	1.6	0.6	-5.1	14.7	13.9	13.3	0.38
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	36.3	6439	2.9	1.6	6.6	19.7	17.6	-	0.50
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	293.6	52634	1.2	0.6	2.4	18.7	20.8	15.9	0.66
-	Quant Multi Cap	629.6	7466	1.9	0.7	2.1	12.6	12.9	17.1	0.34
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	364.7	2807	2.0	0.9	-1.0	14.7	15.0	14.7	0.45

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	104.4	15911	1.8	0.6	8.0	24.3	21.0	18.7	0.59
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	197.3	94745	1.4	0.8	6.6	22.8	21.2	17.9	0.67
*****	Quant Mid Cap	214.0	7905	1.8	0.9	-2.1	17.0	17.1	16.6	0.50
*****	Invesco India Midcap	181.0	11767	1.5	0.5	8.7	25.0	21.3	18.2	0.56
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	34.8	4688	2.3	0.9	7.7	23.6	19.8	-	0.56
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	90.8	35735	1.6	0.8	-8.3	19.8	22.9	16.3	0.59
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4334.2	45820	1.3	0.6	9.2	24.3	22.1	18.8	0.65
***	Axis Midcap	114.9	32276	1.3	0.4	6.2	18.4	15.8	16.7	0.45
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	107.7	2389	1.7	0.5	10.1	20.7	17.9	15.8	0.52
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	333.6	7557	1.8	1.0	19.0	25.7	20.7	17.5	0.61
***	Kotak Midcap	137.7	63539	1.4	0.4	8.5	20.8	18.9	17.7	0.55
***	PGIM India Midcap	62.8	10738	1.7	0.5	1.2	12.7	13.8	15.6	0.40
***	SBI Midcap	234.5	23247	1.6	0.9	1.3	14.7	16.6	14.1	0.50
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1420.4	13378	1.7	0.9	7.3	23.1	19.9	15.0	0.57
***	Tata Mid Cap	443.5	5604	1.9	0.7	8.0	19.9	17.5	16.2	0.52
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	795.0	6290	1.6	0.9	5.1	19.2	17.2	13.8	0.50
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2657.5	12102	1.8	1.0	-0.4	19.3	16.3	14.5	0.46
**	Taurus Mid Cap	115.4	123	2.6	2.2	-1.5	13.6	12.9	14.8	0.35
**	UTI Mid Cap	298.1	11680	2.1	1.3	3.6	16.0	15.1	14.1	0.42
**	DSP Midcap	148.5	19459	1.7	0.7	5.5	19.0	13.7	14.9	0.39
**	HSBC Midcap	429.0	13387	1.5	0.6	16.5	26.5	19.5	17.2	0.49
**	LIC MF Midcap	29.0	347	2.4	1.3	2.5	19.1	15.2	-	0.40

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	171.7	72673	1.2	0.6	6.1	20.1	22.0	20.7	0.58
*****	Quant Small Cap	260.8	30374	1.7	0.8	5.5	19.9	20.3	19.0	0.52
*****	AXIS Small Cap	106.3	27364	1.4	0.4	4.8	17.1	17.8	18.0	0.54

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	49.1	2168	1.7	0.5	11.1	21.0	19.9	-	0.49
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	42.4	11038	1.5	0.4	7.7	23.4	21.8	-	0.56
*****	DSP Small Cap	201.6	17906	1.7	0.8	10.5	19.6	18.8	16.4	0.51
*****	HDFC Small Cap	132.0	38168	1.6	0.8	0.7	15.1	18.4	17.4	0.51
*****	ICICI Pru Smallcap	85.0	8741	1.8	0.8	2.4	14.5	17.5	16.1	0.55
*****	Kotak Small Cap	254.0	17416	1.7	0.6	2.4	14.6	15.4	16.7	0.41
*****	Sundaram Small Cap	272.5	3563	1.9	0.9	9.9	20.0	19.0	14.7	0.49
*****	Tata Small Cap	35.1	11330	1.7	0.4	-7.2	12.2	16.5	-	0.45
*****	Union Small Cap	53.3	1980	1.8	0.8	17.6	20.8	19.1	16.2	0.47
**	Franklin Ind Small Cap	169.5	13850	1.8	1.0	1.5	17.6	19.5	15.3	0.51
**	HSBC Small Cap	81.4	16394	1.4	0.6	5.0	16.9	19.8	18.4	0.48
**	SBI Small Cap	165.1	37141	1.6	0.9	-0.6	12.4	14.5	17.4	0.44
*	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	89.8	5253	1.6	0.8	9.8	17.9	15.0	13.2	0.38
*	LIC MF Small Cap	31.1	660	2.8	1.5	6.8	18.1	18.7	-	0.46
-	Edelara Robeco Small Cap	38.4	13276	1.5	0.5	3.5	15.2	19.0	-	0.51
-	Delawareiss Small Cap	44.3	5952	2.1	0.8	6.3	18.4	17.9	-	0.53

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %ann	3 Month %ann	6 Month %ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2114.3	1048	0.4	0.2	4.8	6.3	6.1	6.0	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	443.2	56604	0.3	0.2	5.0	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- Axis Liquid	3063.7	51643	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3320.4	17385	0.2	0.1	5.0	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3169.1	1735	0.1	0.1	5.0	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3160.9	11412	0.3	0.1	5.1	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3311.7	6395	0.1	0.1	5.1	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- DSP Liquidity	3927.3	22480	0.2	0.1	4.9	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3519.1	15091	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- Groww Liquid	2660.0	278	0.2	0.1	5.2	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- HDFC Liquid	5396.0	72873	0.3	0.2	5.0	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
- HSBC Liquid	2741.6	17559	0.2	0.1	4.9	6.5	6.2	6.2	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	407.0	54639	0.3	0.2	5.1	6.4	6.2	6.1	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3780.3	16549	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- ITI Liquid	1431.0	55	0.2	0.2	5.0	6.3	6.0	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	75.0	2835	0.3	0.2	5.0	6.3	6.1	6.1	-
- Kotak Liquid	5556.9	42389	0.3	0.2	4.9	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- LIC MF Liquid	4971.9	15638	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1789.9	1059	0.3	0.2	4.9	6.5	6.2	6.2	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2882.6	13590	0.2	0.1	4.8	6.4	6.2	6.1	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.5	974	0.4	0.2	4.6	5.9	5.8	5.7	-
- Navi Liquid	29.8	76	0.2	0.2	4.7	5.7	5.6	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6711.0	37903	0.3	0.2	5.0	6.5	6.2	6.2	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1525.1	5260	0.2	0.1	4.9	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- PGIM India Liquid	358.1	584	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.6	6.3	6.2	4.30
- Quant Liquid	43.3	1266	0.6	0.3	4.4	5.5	5.6	5.7	-
- Quantum Liquid	36.7	529	0.3	0.2	4.6	5.7	5.6	5.7	-
- SBI Liquid	4297.2	74571	0.3	0.2	5.0	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2423.4	7086	0.4	0.1	4.9	6.4	6.1	6.1	-
- Tata Liquid	4331.2	27400	0.3	0.2	4.9	6.5	6.2	6.2	-
- Union Liquid	2646.8	8163	0.2	0.1	5.2	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
- UTI Liquid	4513.6	31184	0.3	0.2	5.0	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1477.8	568	0.3	0.2	4.8	6.4	6.1	6.0	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1453.2	6108	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Axis Overnight	1429.3	11376	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.2	5.4	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1434.1	632	0.1	0.0	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1374.0	43	0.1	0.1	6.3	5.6	5.4	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1416.9	867	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1397.6	296	0.7	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1443.2	2116	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1396.9	208	0.2	0.2	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1409.0	949	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	5.4	-
- Groww Overnight	1387.3	83	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- HDFC Overnight	3975.8	9431	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1406.3	4223	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1451.4	11369	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1364.4	337	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1362.5	16	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.8	4.8	5.1	-
- JM Overnight	1367.2	89	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.8	4.9	5.2	-
- Kotak Overnight	1436.4	7487	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1393.5	530	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1393.4	128	0.3	0.2	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1381.6	1389	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	144.6	6199	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1390.9	44	0.2	0.2	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4347.3	27043	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1429.4	624	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1419.2	4376	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Union Overnight	1416.6	411	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- UTI Overnight	3668.9	5730	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.9	25679	0.9	0.3	4.6	5.6	6.0	5.9	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.7	9718	0.9	0.3	4.4	5.7	6.0	5.9	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.0	7895	0.9	0.3	4.5	5.4	5.7	5.7	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.5	45	0.9	0.4	6.0	5.6	5.8	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.8	1255	0.9	0.3	5.0	5.3	5.6	5.7	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.7	6512	0.9	0.3	4.4	5.6	5.8	5.8	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.4	14717	1.1	0.4	4.8	5.7	6.0	5.9	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.2	24439	0.9	0.4	4.7	5.8	6.0	6.0	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.0	2532	0.8	0.2	4.8	6.1	6.1	6.0	-
- ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	36.1	32299	0.9	0.4	5.0	5.9	6.1	6.0	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.6	27321	0.9	0.3	4.9	5.7	6.1	6.1	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.6	88	0.9	0.3	4.7	5.8	6.3	6.1	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.2	367	1.5	0.8	5.6	5.6	5.9	5.7	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.4	69951	1.0	0.4	4.9	5.9	6.1	6.0	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.5	244	0.9	0.3	5.1	5.9	6.0	5.7	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.9	112	1.1	0.4	4.4	5.2	5.5	5.3	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.7	3461	0.8	0.1	5.2	5.5	5.9	5.8	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.9	16332	0.9	0.3	5.2	5.7	6.0	5.9	0.80
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.3	97	1.0	0.4	6.0	6.2	6.0	5.5	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.6	42847	0.9	0.4	5.2	5.9	6.2	6.1	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.2	442	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.2	6.2	5.9	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.1	21824	1.1	0.3	4.7	5.8	6.2	6.0	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.7	239	0.9	0.3	5.1	5.7	5.8	5.7	-
- UTI Arbitrage	36.9	10858	2.4	1.8	4.7	5.7	6.1	6.1	-

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	577.7	19985	0.5	0.3	6.3	7.1	7.2	6.3	10.83
***** Baroda BNPP Ultra Short Duration	1623.5	651	0.4	0.3	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4236.1	11083	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.8	6.7	18.83
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.0	4458	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.0	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.2	15929	0.8	0.4	6.1	6.8	7.0	6.1	8.82
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1377.6	1420	0.4	0.2	6.2	7.0	7.1	6.2	1.41
***** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4447.0	4126	1.0	0.4	5.8	6.5	6.7	6.3	7.74
***** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.4	5916	1.1	0.3	5.7	6.4	6.5	5.6	8.36
*** DSP Ultra Short	3571.8	4167	1.0	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.6	7.24
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.9	16753	0.7	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.9	6.0	4.41
*** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1424.9	3118	0.3	0.1	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2833.5	1073	0.7	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.8	5.8	9.14
*** Kotak Savings	45.1	16824	0.8	0.4	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.9	6.77
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1446.6	212	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.8	5.9	3.55
*** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6283.4	12553	0.6	0.4	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.0	8.65
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1425.9	580	1.1	0.6	5.5	6.3	6.4	5.5	-
** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3316.8	154	0.9	0.4	5.7	6.3	6.3	5.6	7.16
** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1384.7	342	1.4	0.2	5.6	6.3	6.3	5.5	1.58
** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.6	167	0.9	0.4	5.4	6.2	6.4	5.6	3.01
** Tata Ultra Short Term	14.9	5173	1.2	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.6	5.6	8.37
* Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3982.7	498	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.4	-
* Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.2	428	1.2	0.2	5.1	5.5	5.7	4.8	-
* Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2800.7	1817	1.4	0.2	5.0	5.8	5.9	5.1	1.71

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	572.6	27700	0.6	0.4	6.1	7.2	7.4	6.5	6.63
***** UTI Low Duration	3731.3	3108	0.4	0.3	6.0	7.1	7.1	7.2	7.09
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3251.8	6084	0.6	0.3	5.9	7.0	7.1	6.1	7.38
***** DSP Low Duration	20.8	5108	0.6	0.3	5.5	6.7	6.8	5.9	-
***** HDFC Low Duration	60.5	21926	1.1	0.5	5.6	6.7	6.9	6.0	12.68

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
*****	HSBC Low Duration	30.1	1058	0.8	0.3	5.7	7.5	7.4	6.2	9.66
***	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	686.2	13267	1.0	0.4	5.3	6.4	6.6	5.7	10.00
***	Bandhan Low Duration	40.4	6121	0.6	0.3	5.6	6.7	6.8	5.9	-
***	Canara Robeco Savings	44.2	1140	0.4	0.2	5.8	6.8	6.9	5.9	-
***	Invesco India Low Duration	3969.2	1690	0.5	0.3	5.7	6.8	6.9	5.9	6.04
***	JM Low Duration	38.8	223	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.7	6.8	5.8	5.59
***	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3925.4	9417	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.8	6.8	5.9	7.52
***	SBI Low Duration	3653.8	13458	0.9	0.4	5.4	6.6	6.7	5.7	3.92
***	Tata Treasury Advantage	4123.4	2859	0.6	0.3	5.7	6.8	6.8	5.9	3.99
**	Kotak Low Duration	3500.5	16259	1.2	0.4	5.4	6.6	6.7	5.8	11.10
**	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1711.4	561	1.1	0.4	5.4	6.5	6.6	5.6	13.58
**	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2364.7	2314	0.7	0.2	5.5	6.7	6.7	5.7	4.97
**	Sundaram Low Duration	3612.4	369	1.1	0.4	5.1	6.4	6.5	5.6	3.53
*	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.9	292	0.9	0.2	5.4	6.4	6.5	5.6	1.72
*	LIC MF Low Duration	41.4	1692	0.5	0.3	5.5	6.5	6.6	5.6	3.12

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

★★★★★	Nippon Ind Money Market	4370.7	21421	0.3	0.2	6.1	7.1	7.2	6.4	-
★★★★★	UTI Money Market	3249.0	19328	0.3	0.2	6.2	7.1	7.3	6.4	-
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	389.6	30074	0.3	0.2	6.1	7.1	7.2	6.4	-
★★★★★	Axis Money Market	1507.8	20121	0.3	0.2	6.2	7.1	7.2	6.3	-
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Money Market	399.6	32702	0.4	0.2	6.1	7.1	7.2	6.3	-
★★★★★	Kotak Money Market	4730.0	33700	0.4	0.2	6.1	7.1	7.2	6.3	-
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1451.3	38103	0.3	0.1	6.1	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★★★★	Franklin Ind Money Market	52.9	4309	0.3	0.1	6.1	7.1	7.2	6.2	-
★★★★	HDFC Money Market	6019.1	29824	0.5	0.2	6.1	7.0	7.2	6.3	-
★★★★	PGIM India Money Market	1394.2	134	0.5	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.8	5.9	-
★★★★	Sundaram Money Market	15.8	1956	0.4	0.2	6.1	7.0	7.1	6.1	-
★★★★	Tata Money Market	4974.4	37476	0.4	0.2	6.2	7.1	7.2	6.3	-
★★★	DSP Savings	55.4	9810	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	5.9	-
★★	HSBC Money Market	27.8	6639	0.3	0.1	6.0	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★★	Invesco India Money Market	3202.2	5938	0.4	0.1	5.9	6.8	6.9	5.9	-
★★	SBI Savings	43.5	36291	0.7	0.3	5.8	6.7	6.8	5.9	-
★	Bandhan Money Market	42.5	15908	0.3	0.1	6.1	6.9	6.9	5.8	-
★	Edelweiss Money Market	29.8	2251	0.7	0.1	5.6	6.5	6.5	5.5	-

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